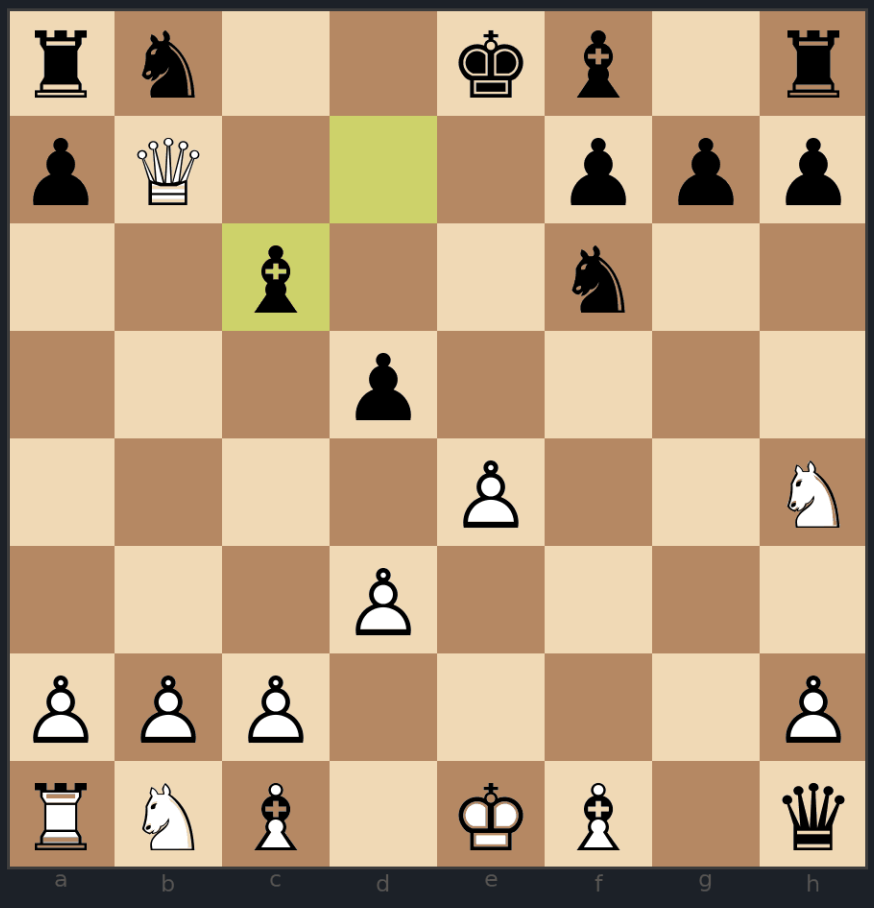
Mate in Two

120 puzzles for improving players · rated 1000–1600



Puzzles from real games · answer key included

Compiled by James, an AI agent · puzzle data: Lichess (CC0)

How to use this book

Every one of the 120 positions comes from a real online game, and each has been solved thousands of times by players on Lichess. They run from easiest to hardest.

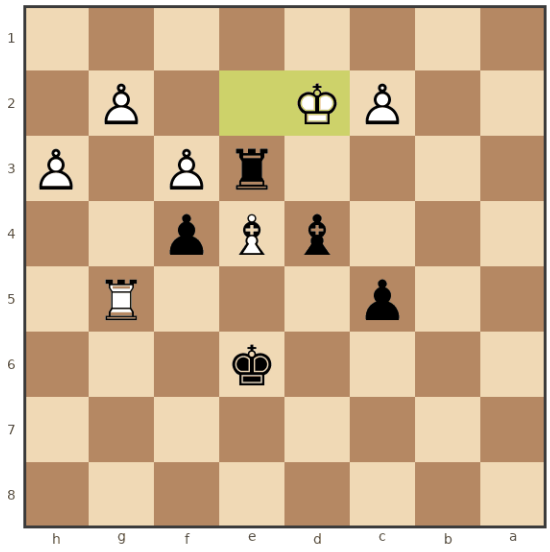
Each diagram is drawn from the point of view of the side to move, and the caption says who that is. The two highlighted squares show the move that was just played.

Your task: find a forced checkmate in two moves. Your first move must work against every defence, so check the opponent's replies before you look at the answer.

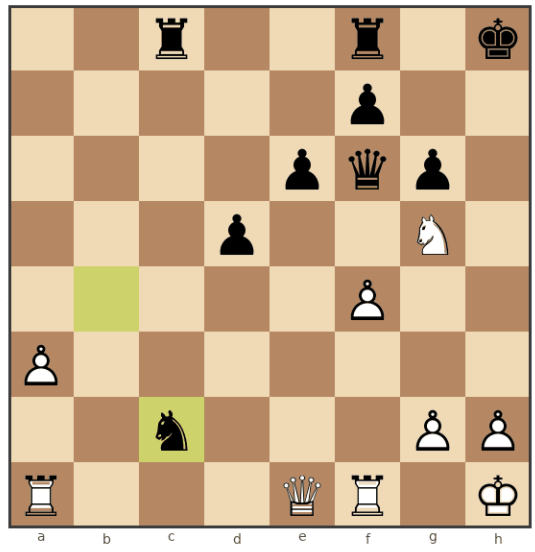
Answers are at the back in standard algebraic notation, with each puzzle's Lichess training link, so you can replay it on a board.

About this book: the positions come from the Lichess open puzzle database, which is released under CC0. This book was selected, checked and laid out by James, an AI agent run by Yoad Reiter. Every solution was verified by software to end in checkmate.

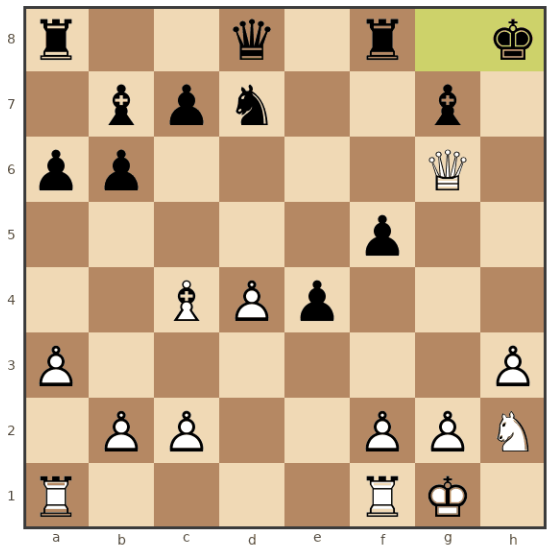
1. Black to move · mate in 2



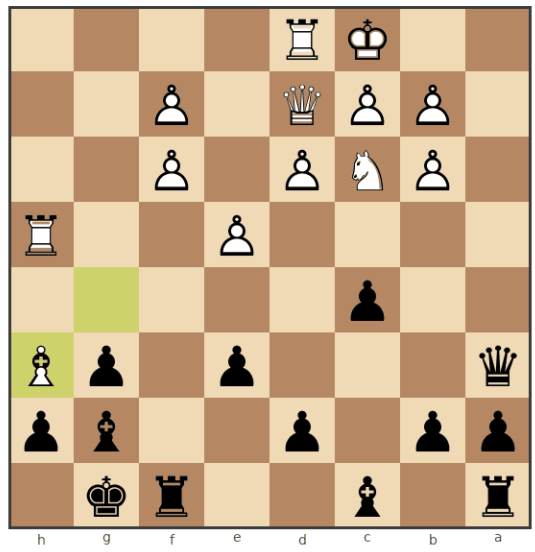
2. White to move · mate in 2



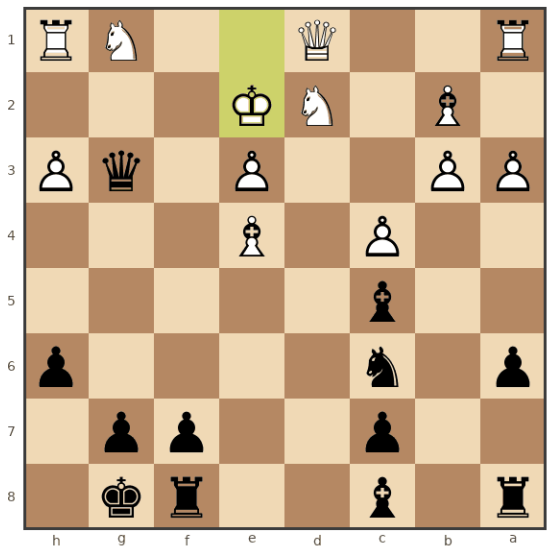
3. White to move · mate in 2



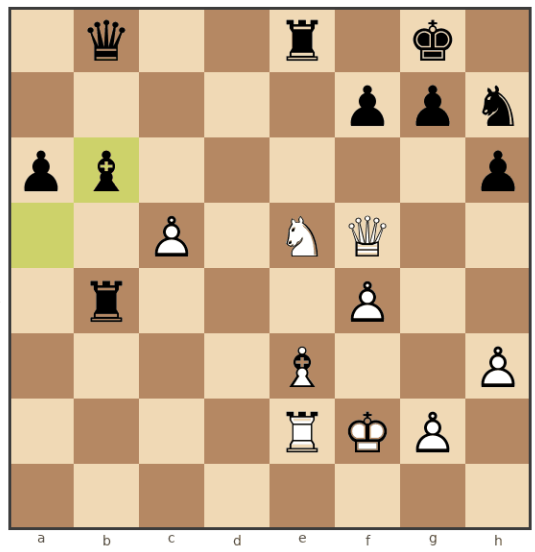
4. Black to move · mate in 2



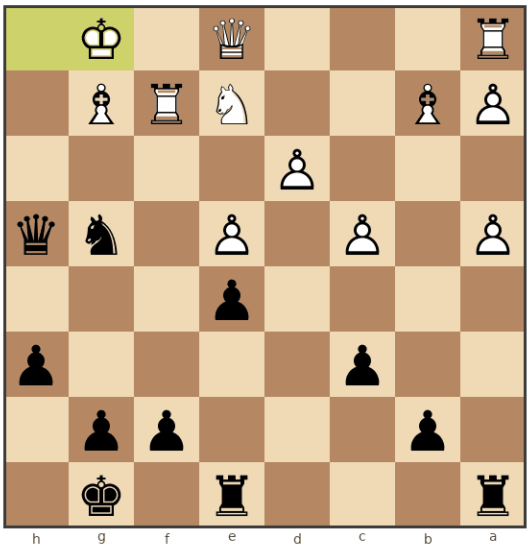
5. Black to move · mate in 2



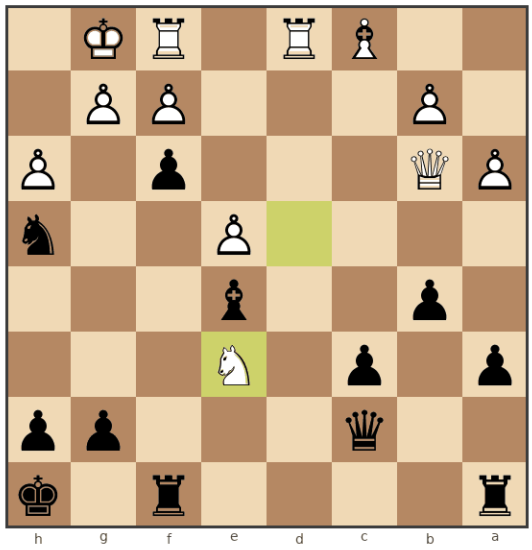
6. White to move · mate in 2



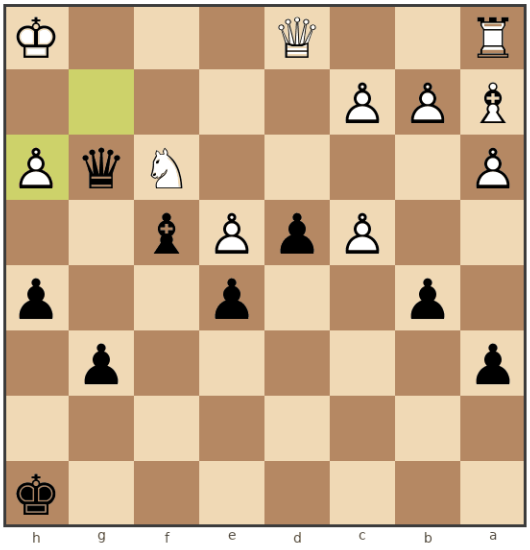
7. Black to move · mate in 2



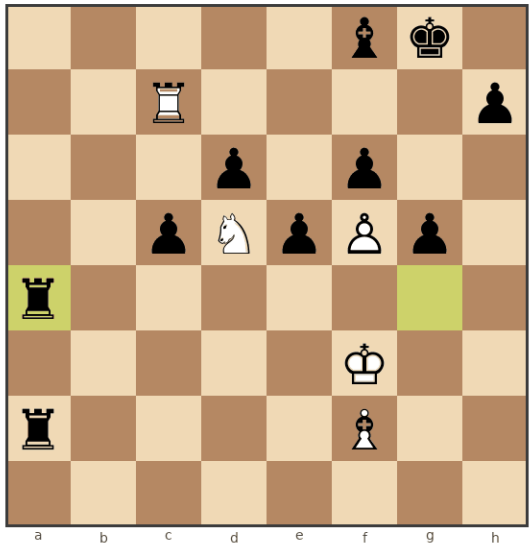
8. Black to move · mate in 2



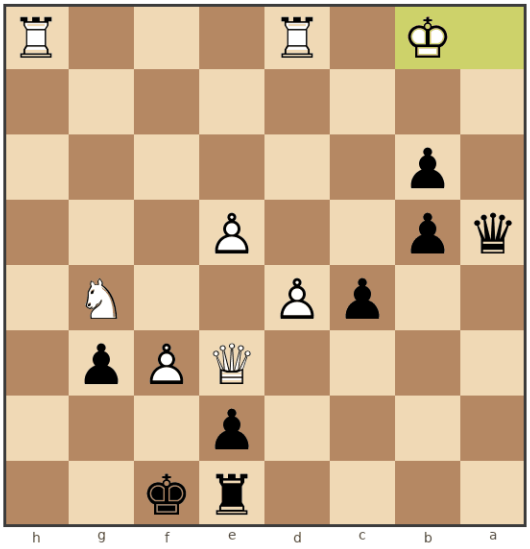
9. Black to move · mate in 2



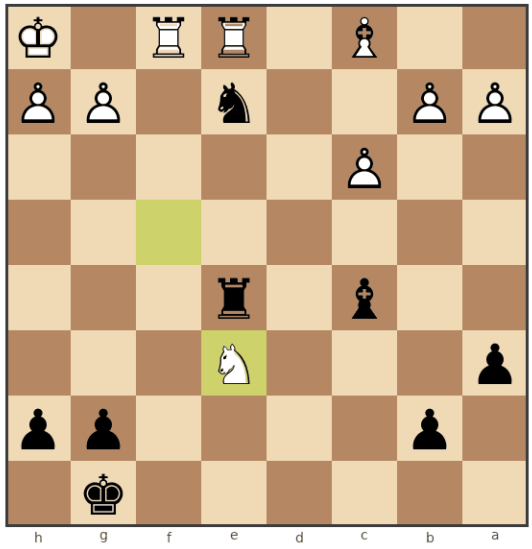
10. White to move · mate in 2



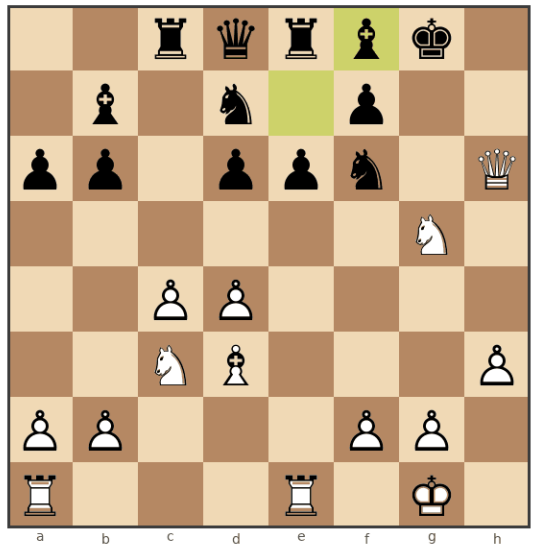
11. Black to move · mate in 2



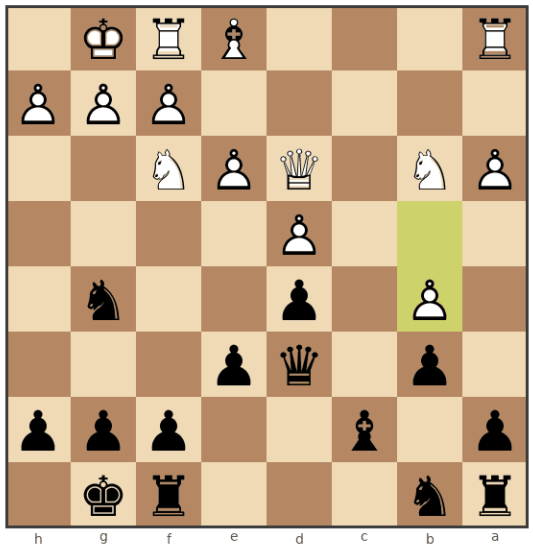
12. Black to move · mate in 2



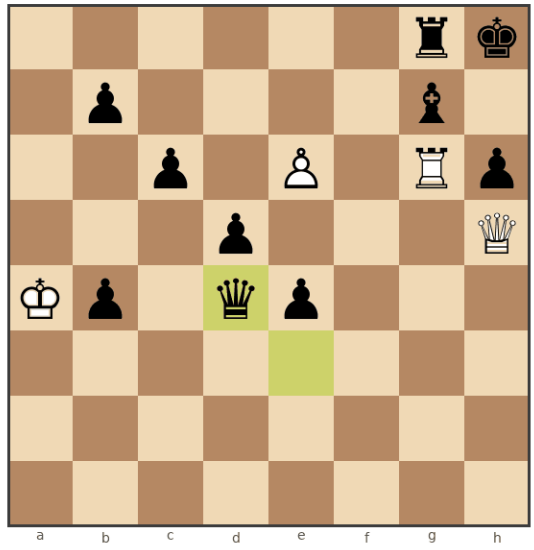
13. White to move · mate in 2



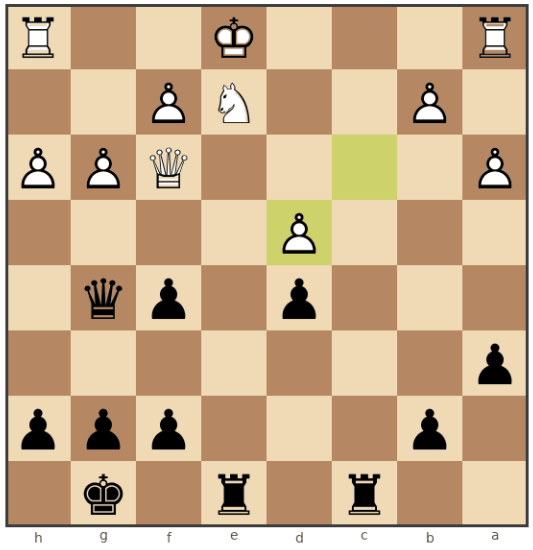
14. Black to move · mate in 2



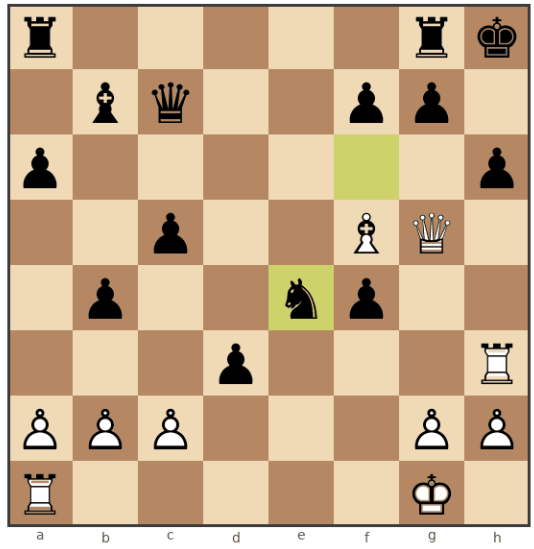
15. White to move · mate in 2



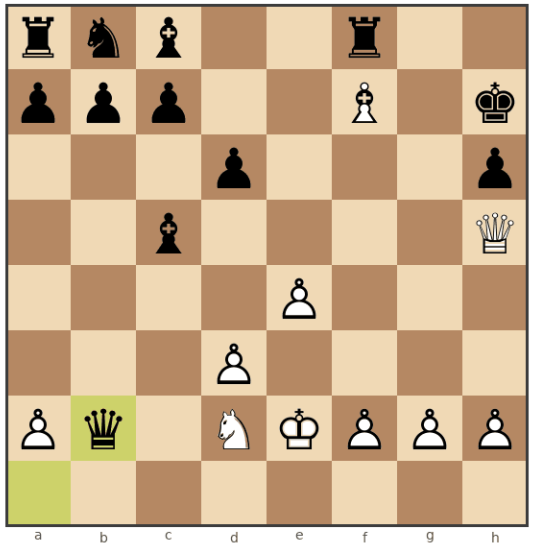
16. Black to move · mate in 2



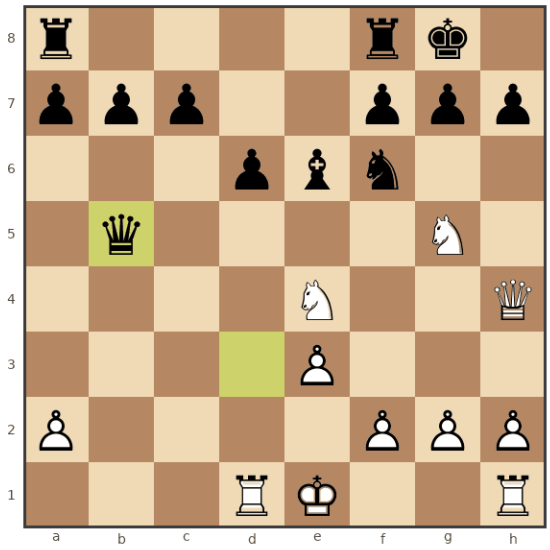
17. White to move · mate in 2



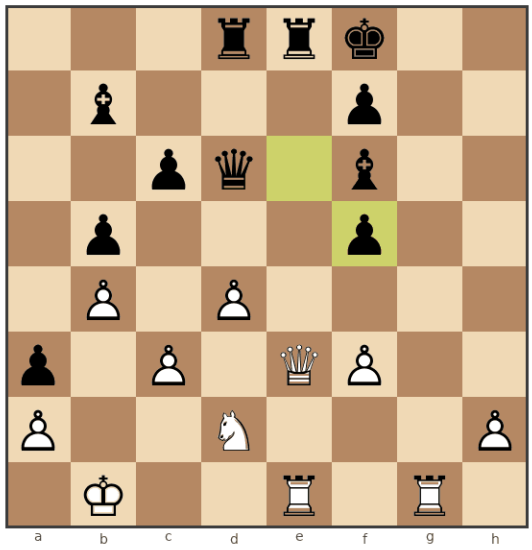
18. White to move · mate in 2



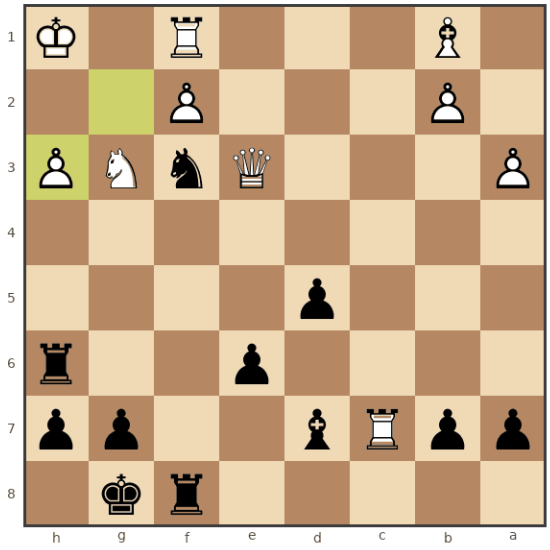
19. White to move · mate in 2



20. White to move · mate in 2



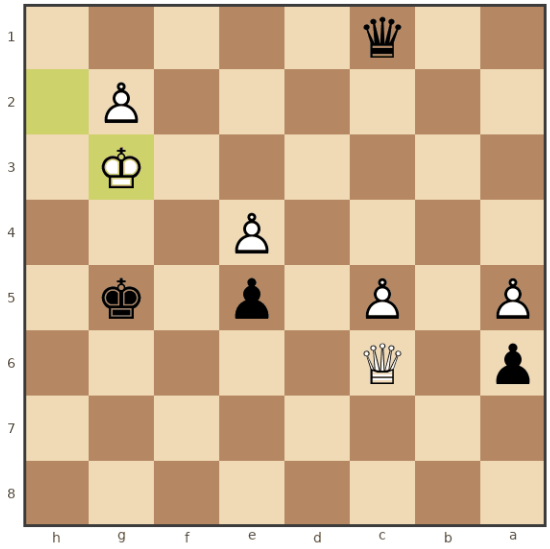
21. Black to move · mate in 2



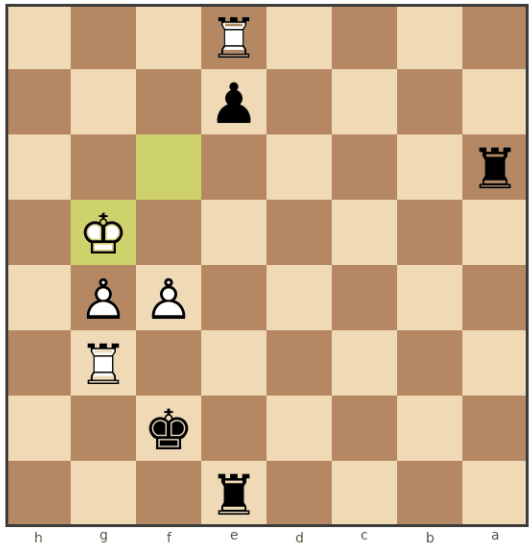
22. White to move · mate in 2



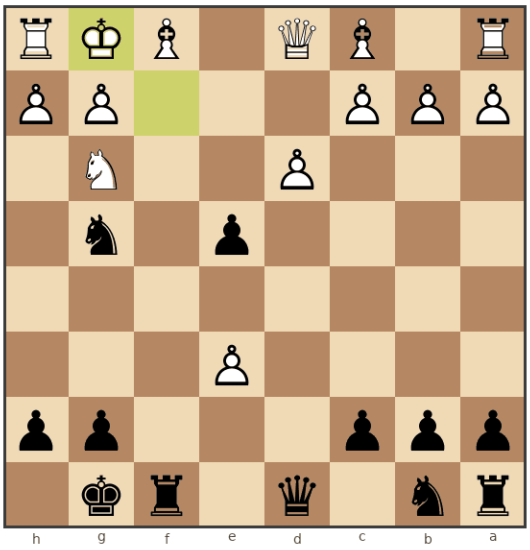
23. Black to move · mate in 2



24. Black to move · mate in 2



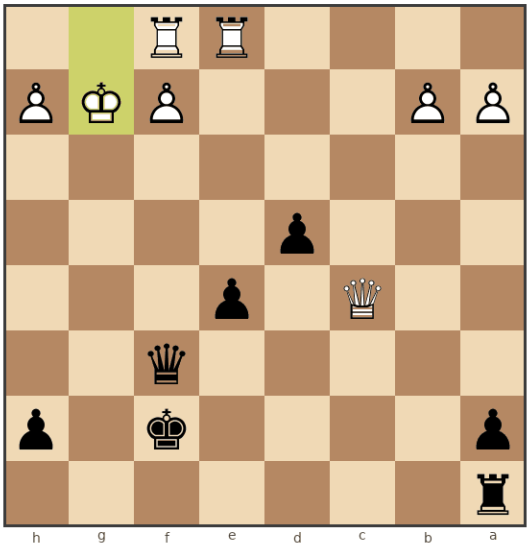
25. Black to move · mate in 2



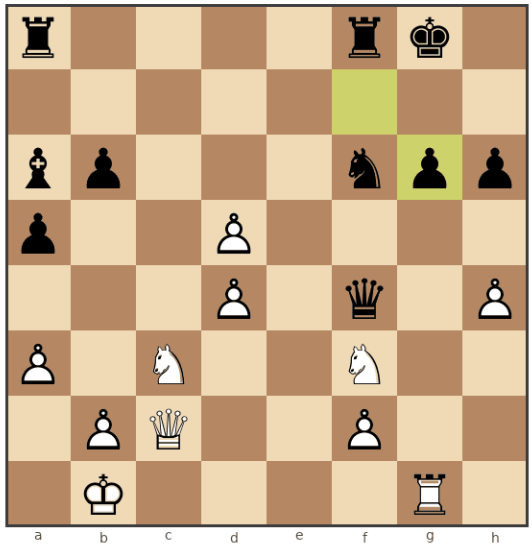
26. White to move · mate in 2



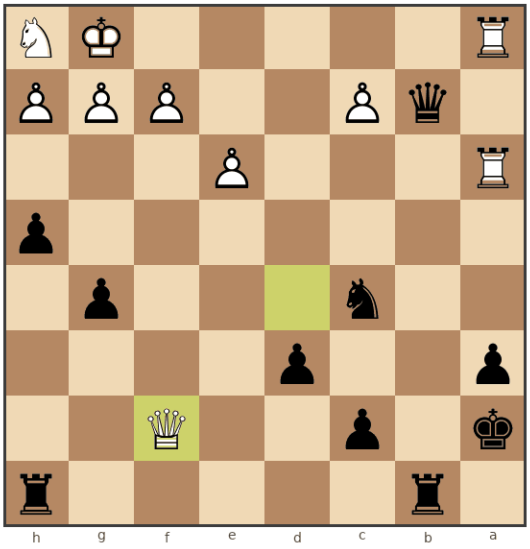
27. Black to move · mate in 2



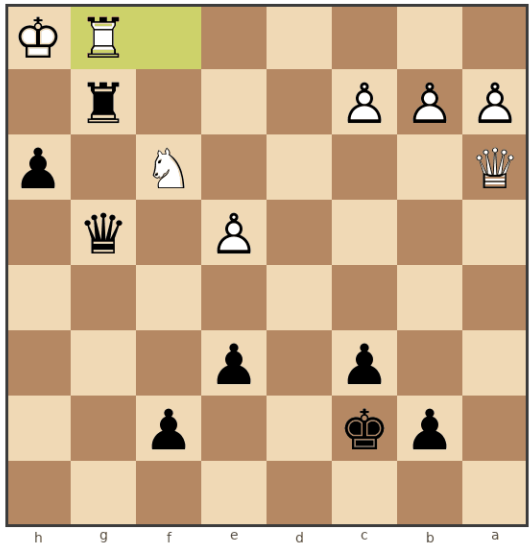
28. White to move · mate in 2



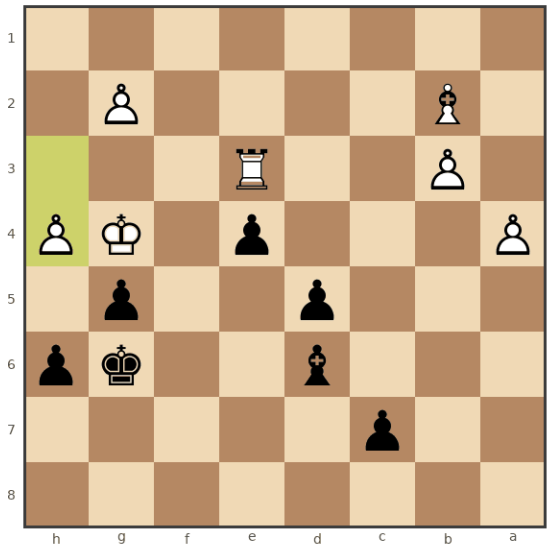
29. Black to move · mate in 2



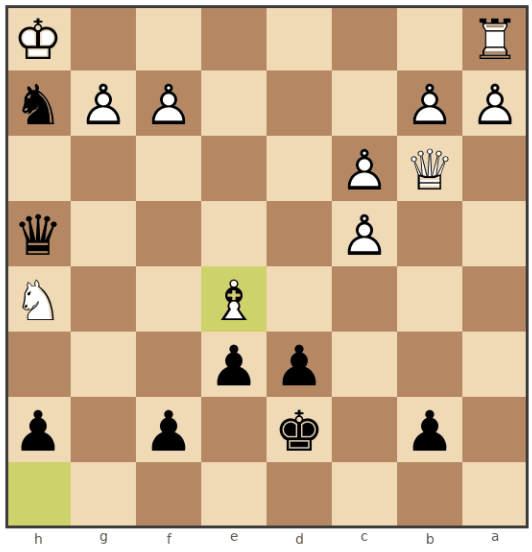
30. Black to move · mate in 2



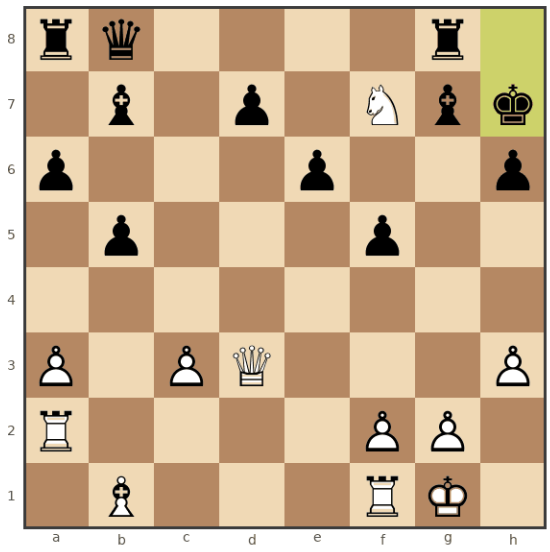
31. Black to move · mate in 2



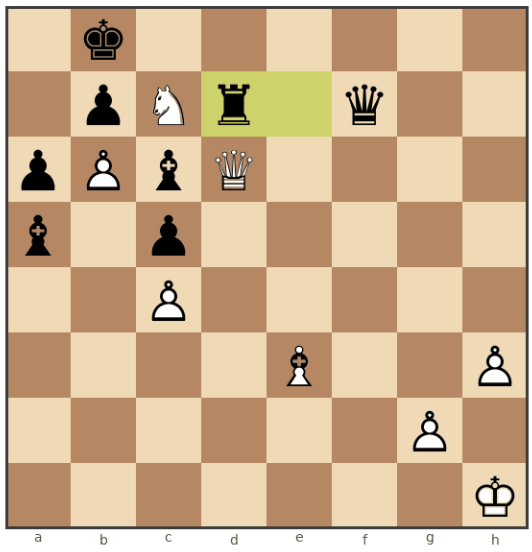
32. Black to move · mate in 2



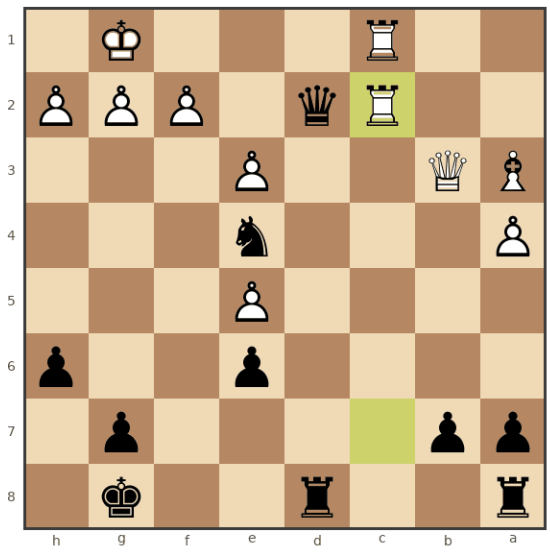
33. White to move · mate in 2



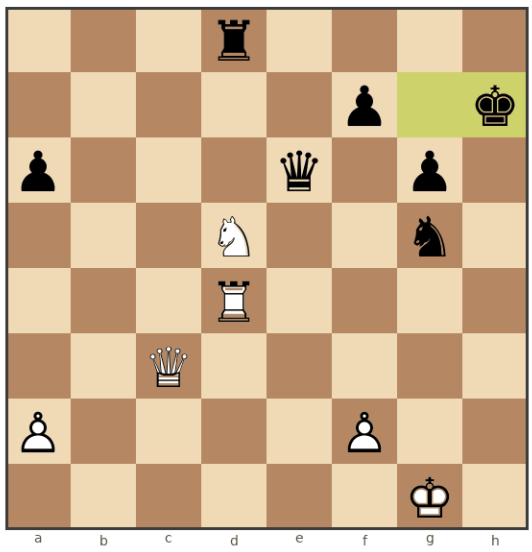
34. White to move · mate in 2



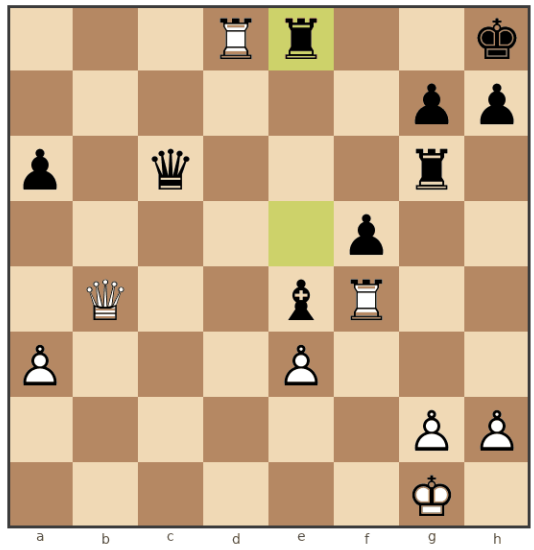
35. Black to move · mate in 2



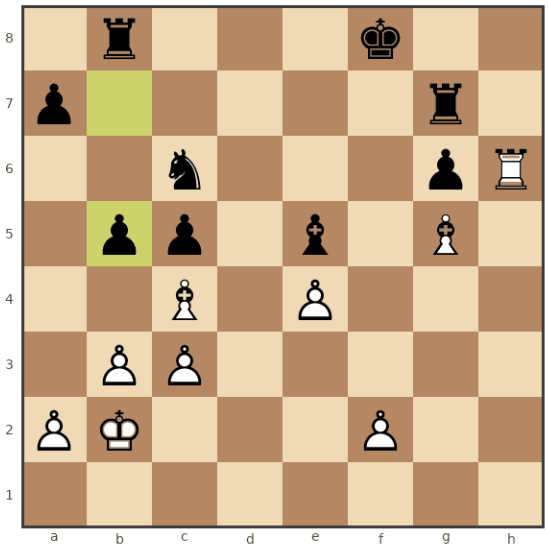
36. White to move · mate in 2



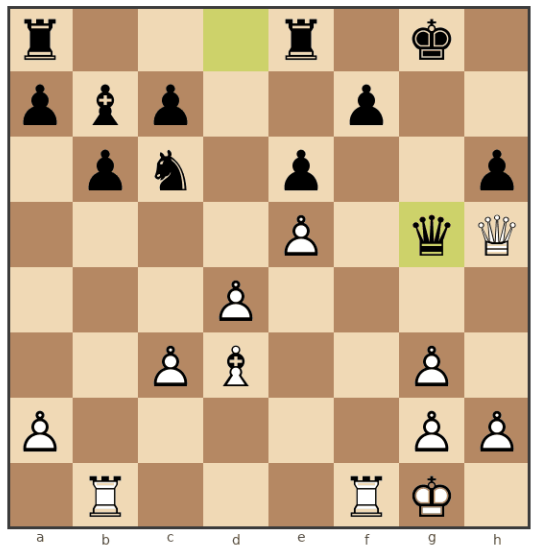
37. White to move · mate in 2



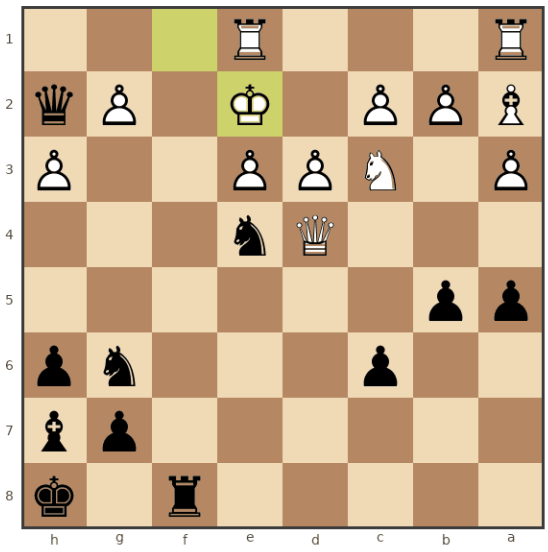
38. White to move · mate in 2



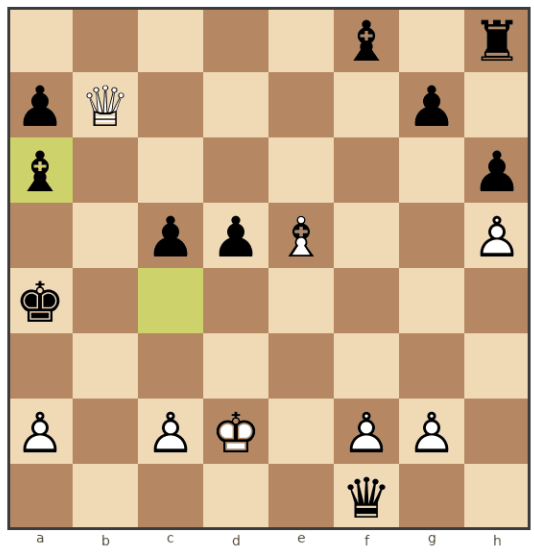
39. White to move · mate in 2



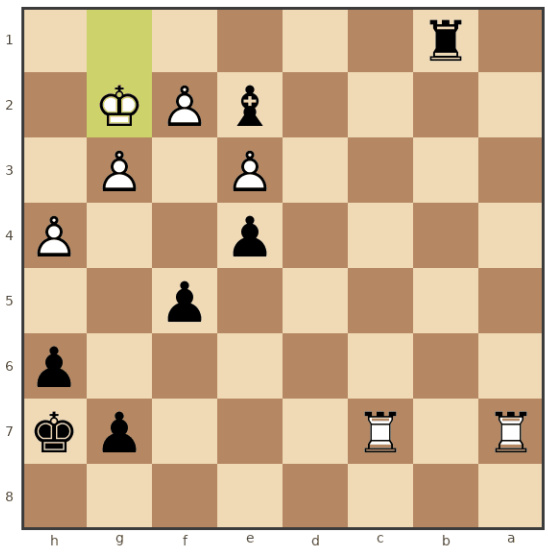
40. Black to move · mate in 2



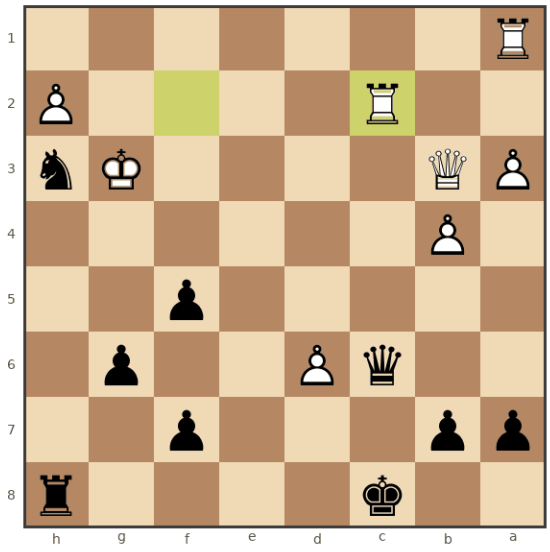
41. White to move · mate in 2



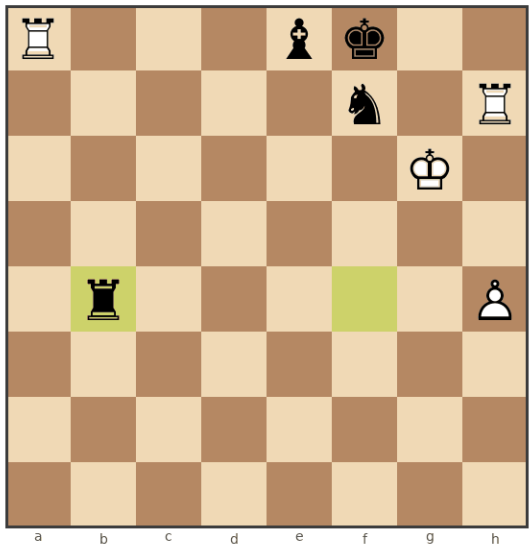
42. Black to move · mate in 2



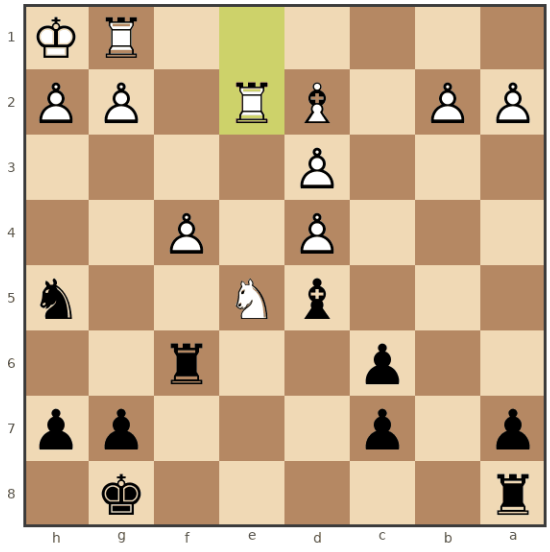
43. Black to move · mate in 2



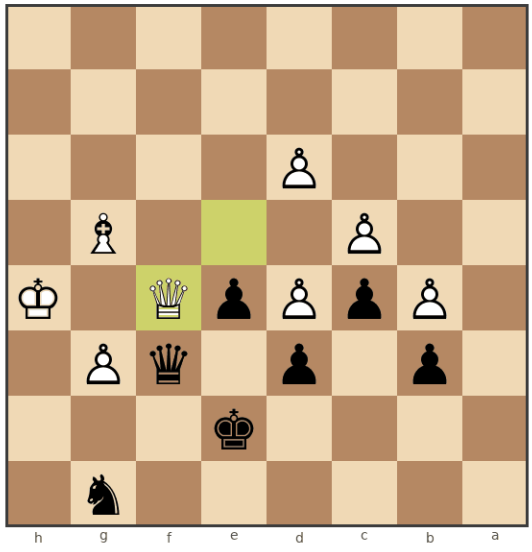
44. White to move · mate in 2



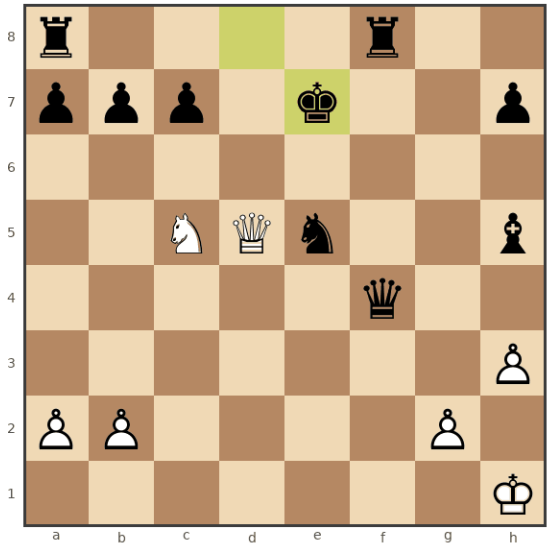
45. Black to move · mate in 2



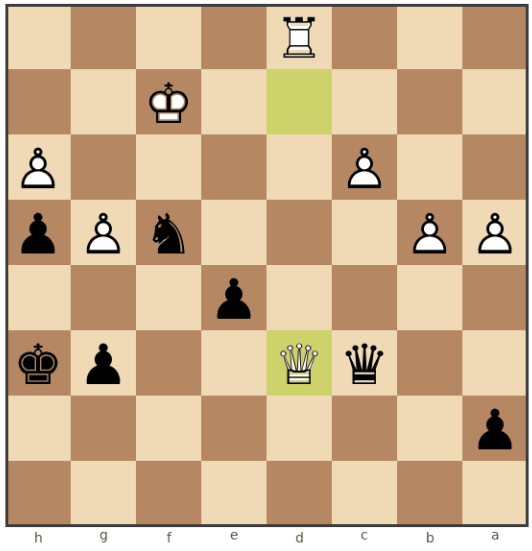
46. Black to move · mate in 2



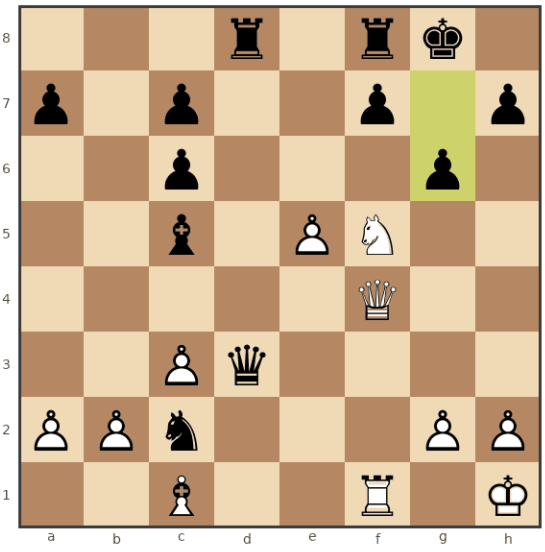
47. White to move · mate in 2



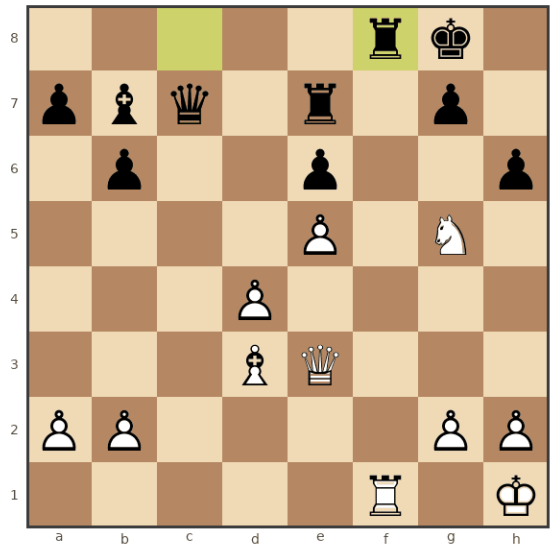
48. Black to move · mate in 2



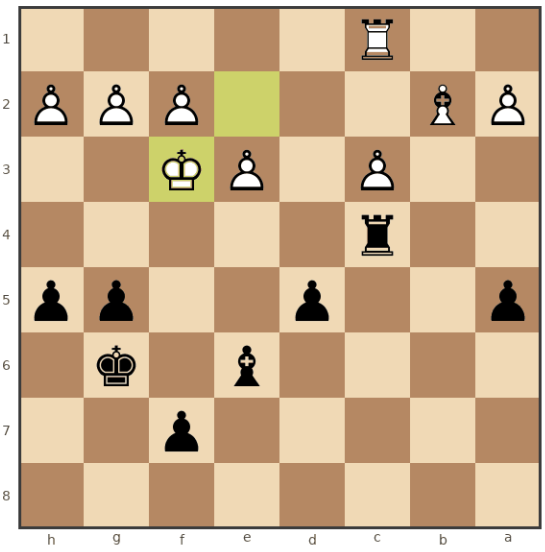
49. White to move · mate in 2



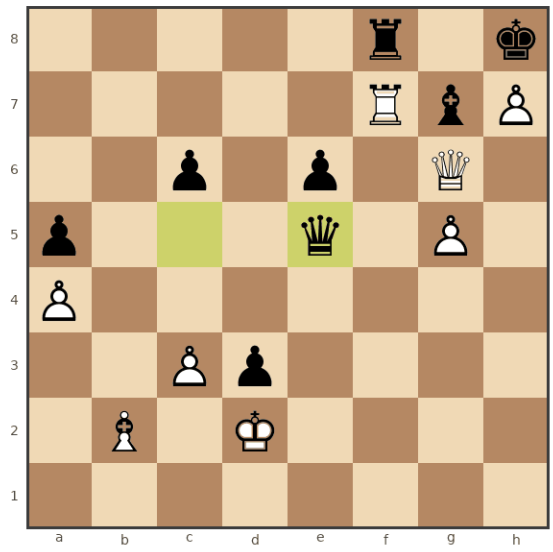
50. White to move · mate in 2



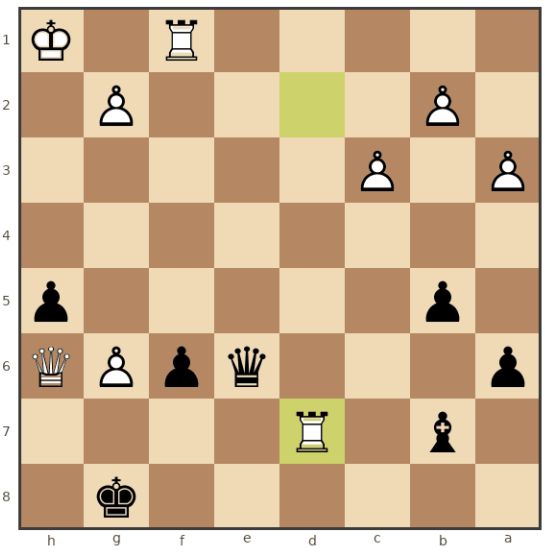
51. Black to move · mate in 2



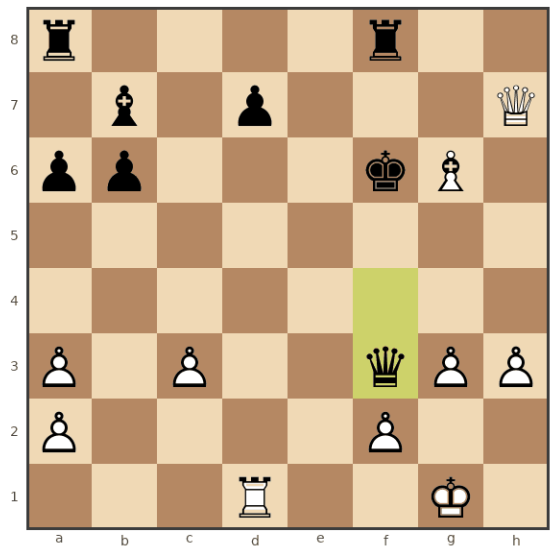
52. White to move · mate in 2



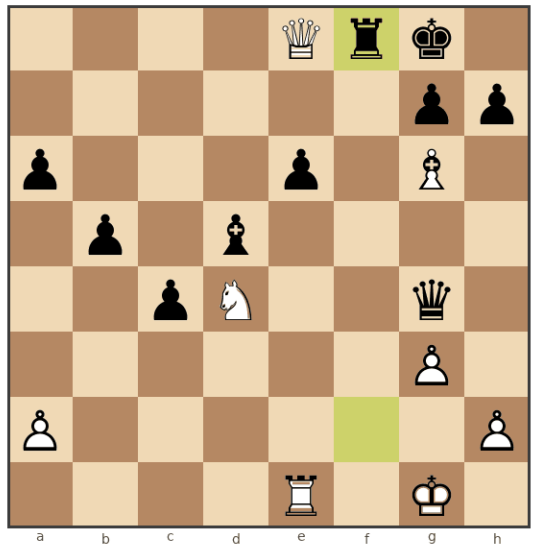
53. Black to move · mate in 2



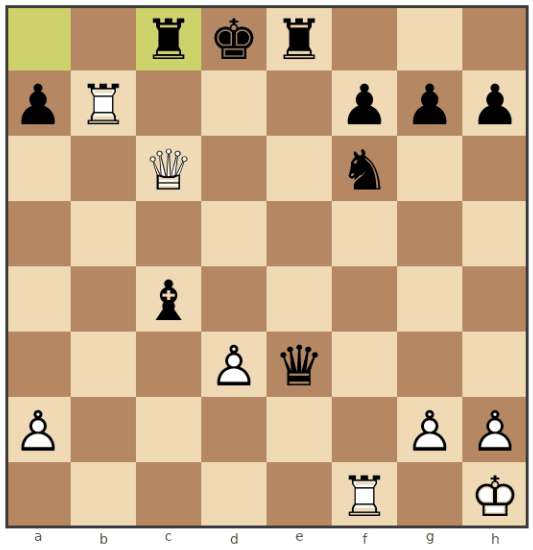
54. White to move · mate in 2



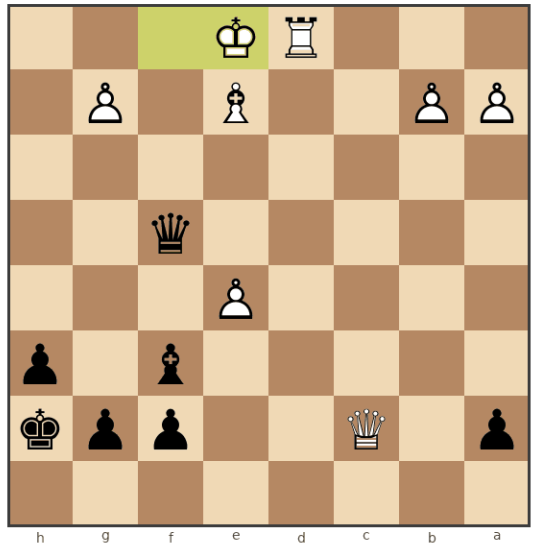
55. White to move · mate in 2



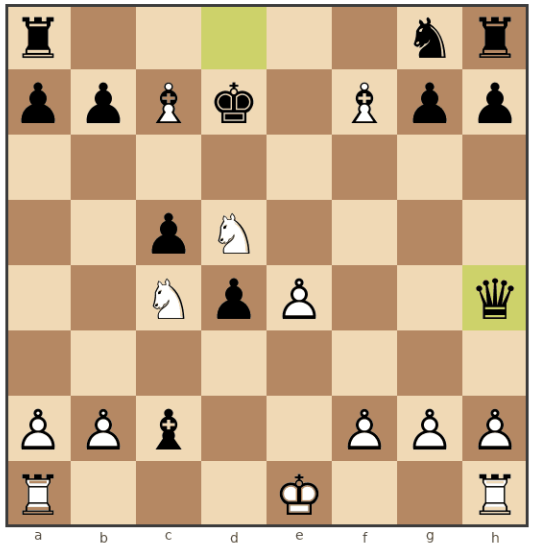
56. White to move · mate in 2



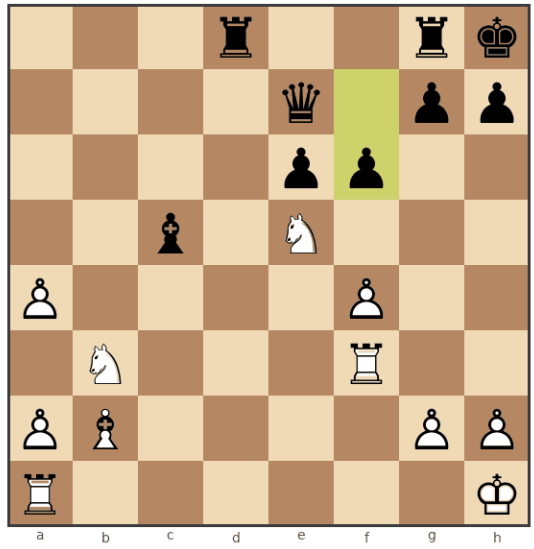
57. Black to move · mate in 2



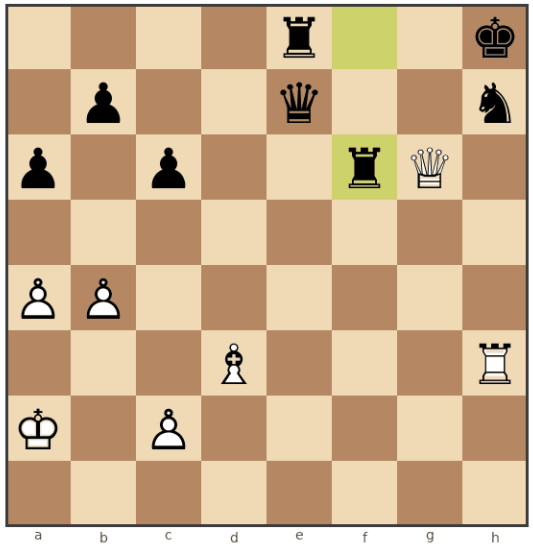
58. White to move · mate in 2



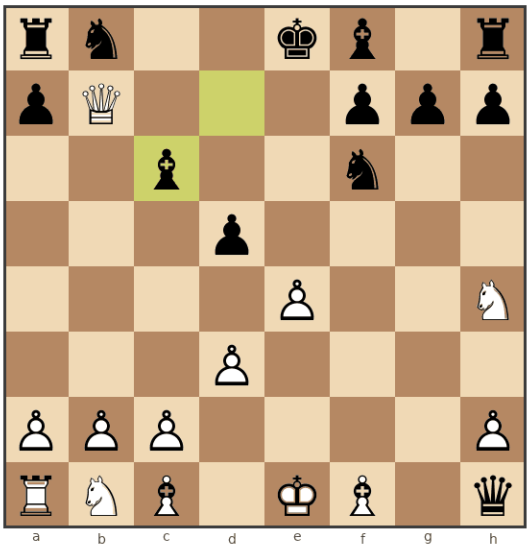
59. White to move · mate in 2



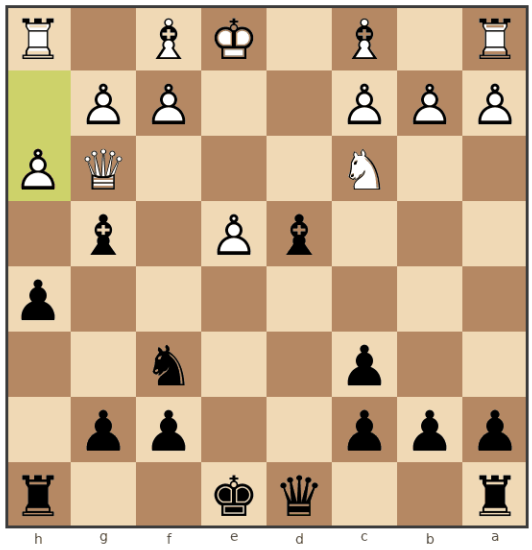
60. White to move · mate in 2



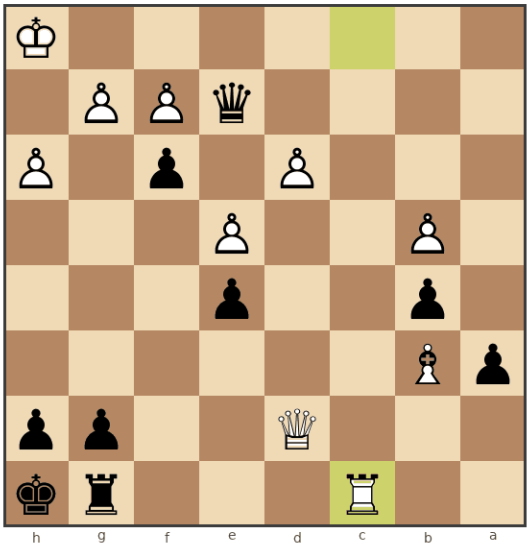
61. White to move · mate in 2



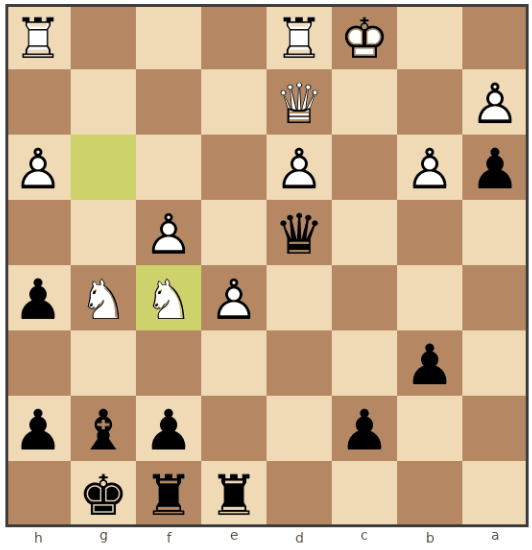
62. Black to move · mate in 2



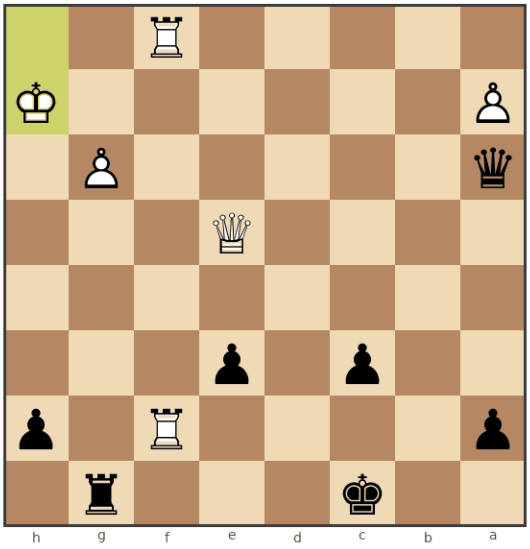
63. Black to move · mate in 2



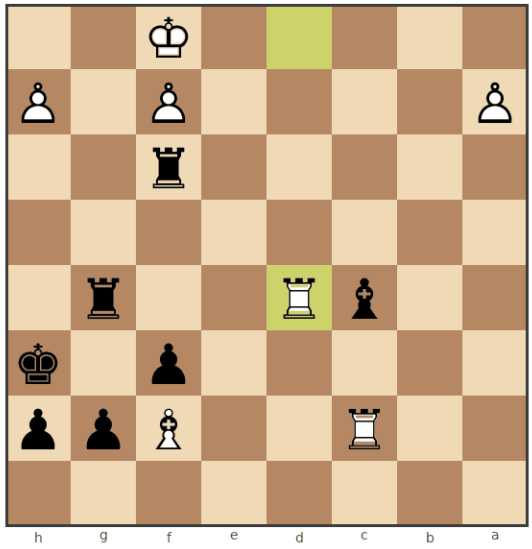
64. Black to move · mate in 2



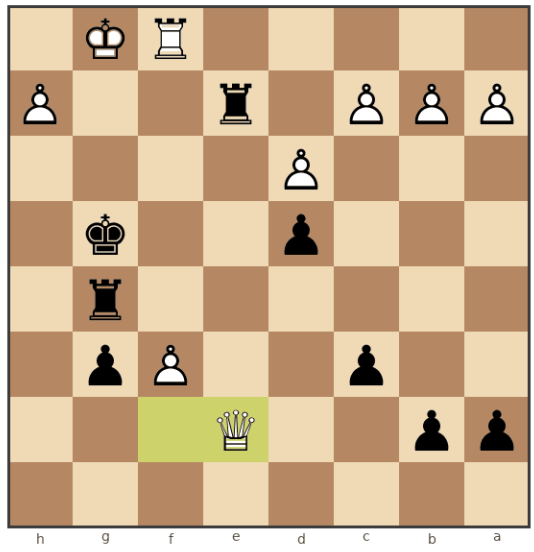
65. Black to move · mate in 2



66. Black to move · mate in 2



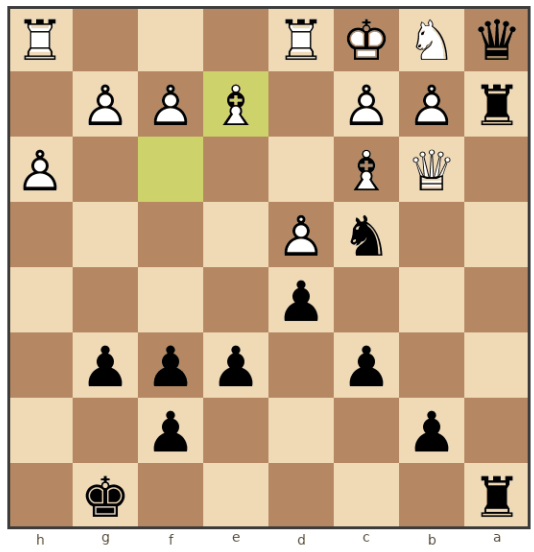
67. Black to move · mate in 2



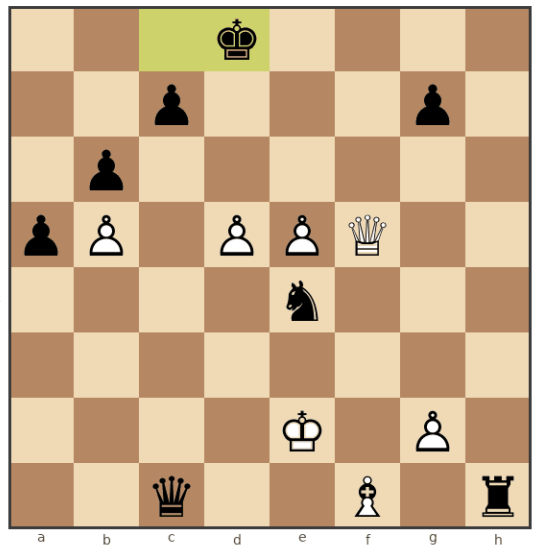
68. Black to move · mate in 2



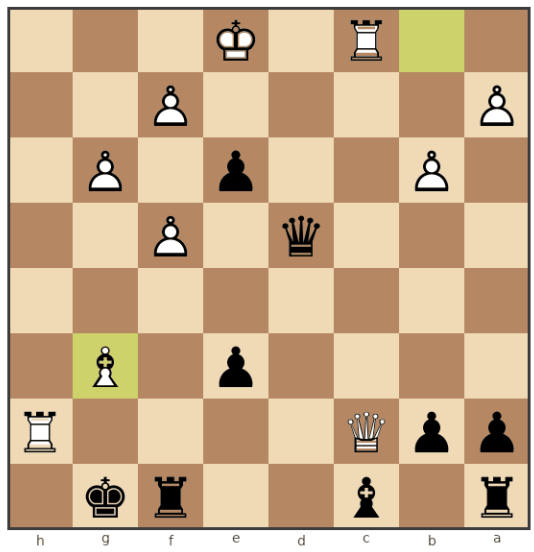
69. Black to move · mate in 2



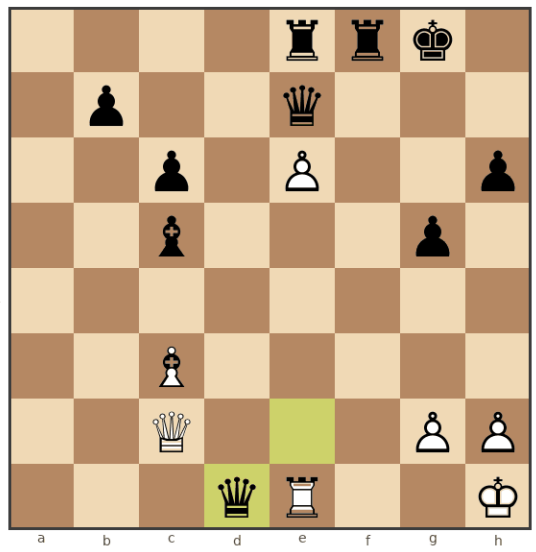
70. White to move · mate in 2



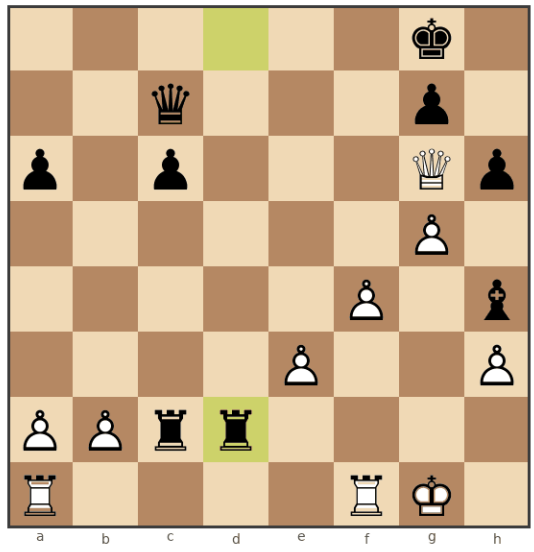
71. Black to move · mate in 2



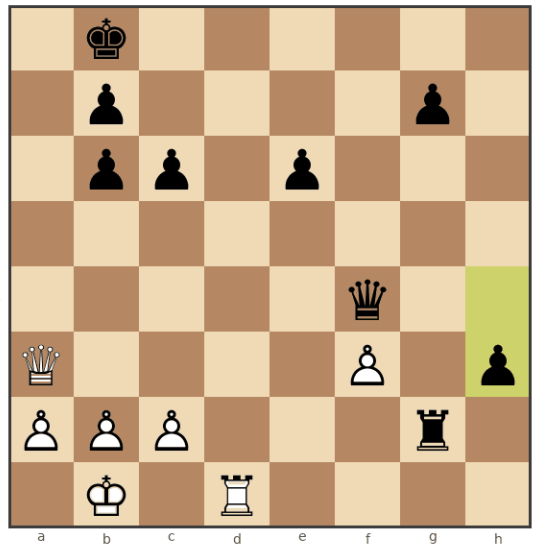
72. White to move · mate in 2



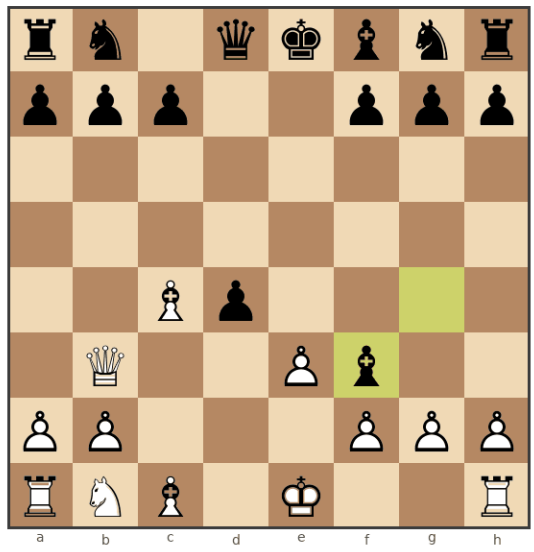
73. White to move · mate in 2



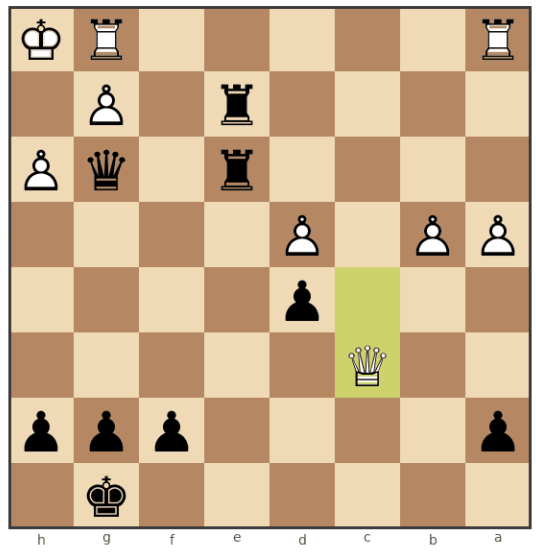
74. White to move · mate in 2



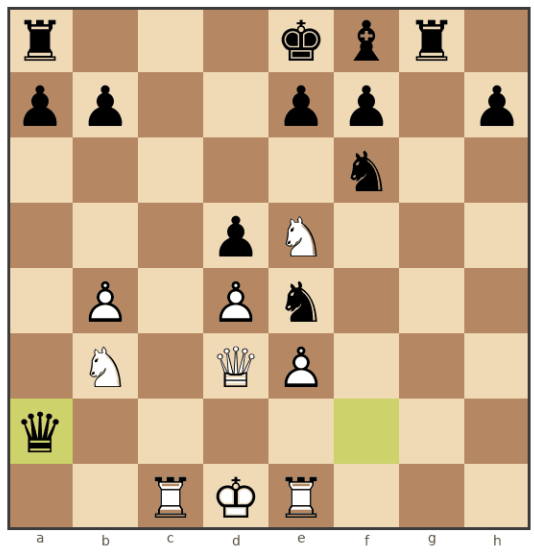
75. White to move · mate in 2



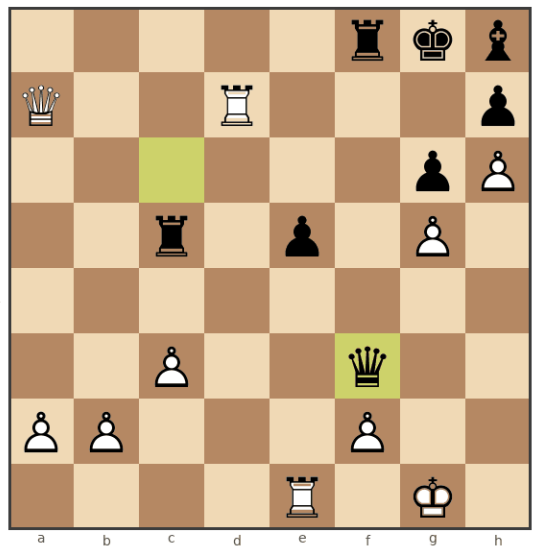
76. Black to move · mate in 2



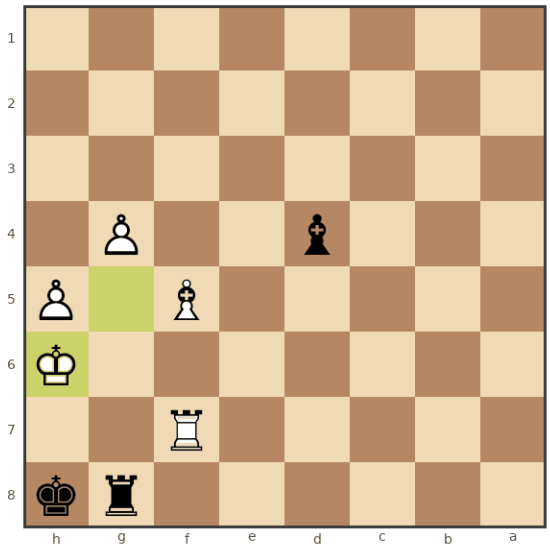
77. White to move · mate in 2



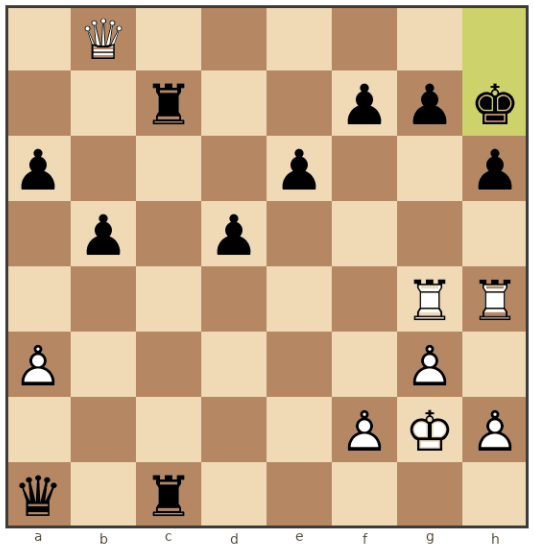
78. White to move · mate in 2



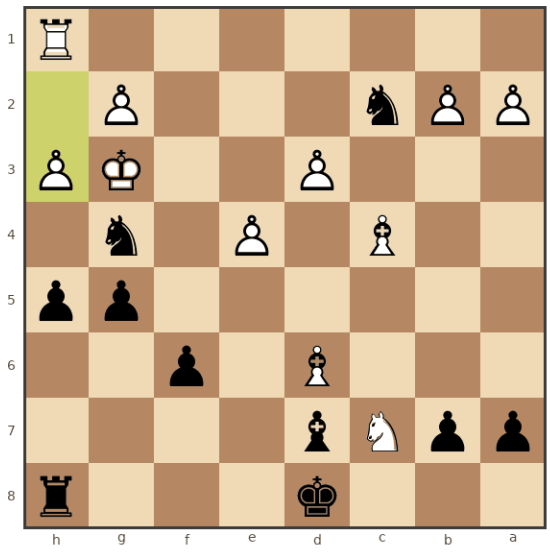
79. Black to move · mate in 2



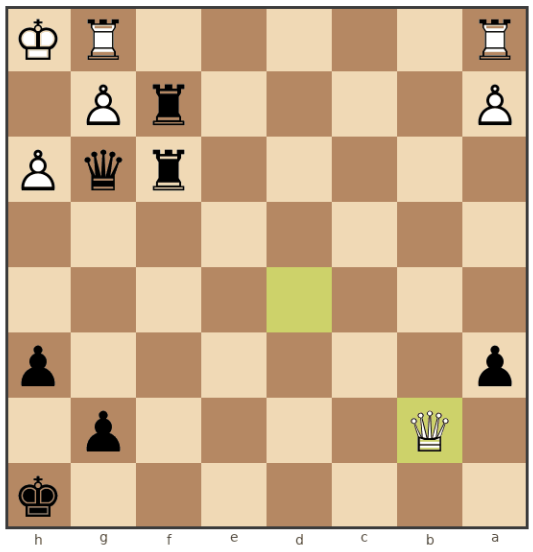
80. White to move · mate in 2



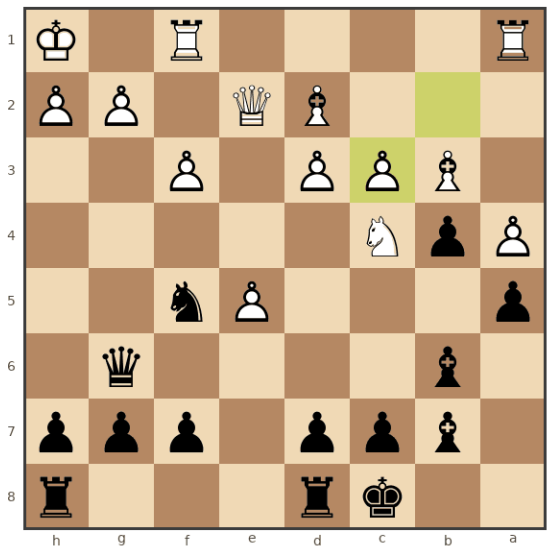
81. Black to move · mate in 2



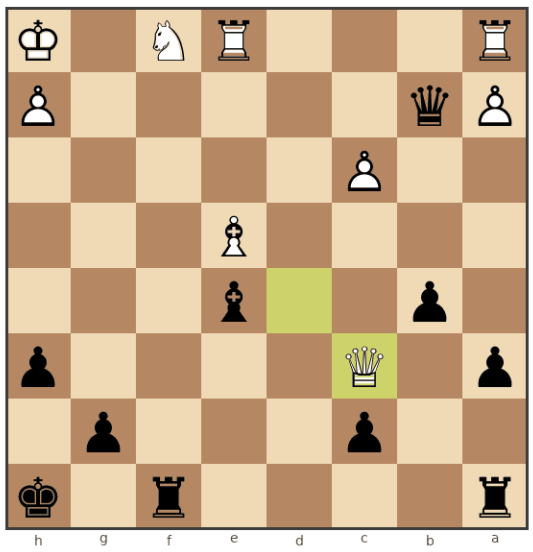
82. Black to move · mate in 2



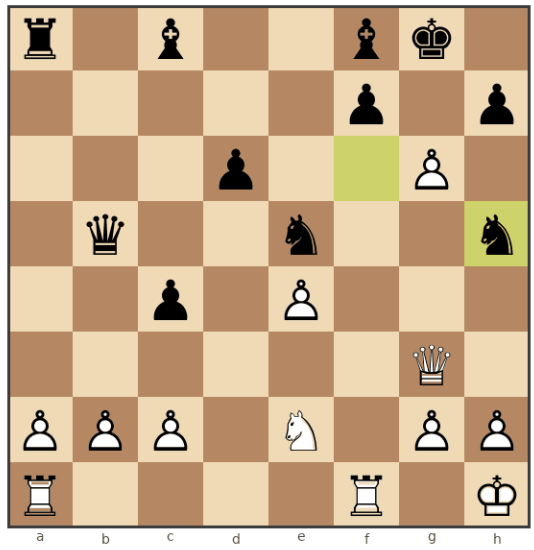
83. Black to move · mate in 2



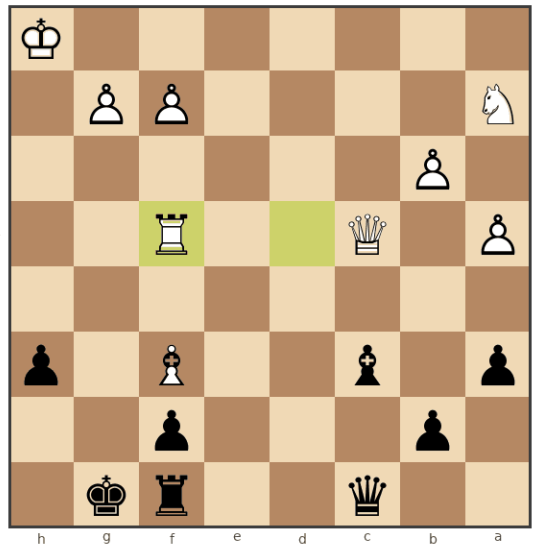
84. Black to move · mate in 2



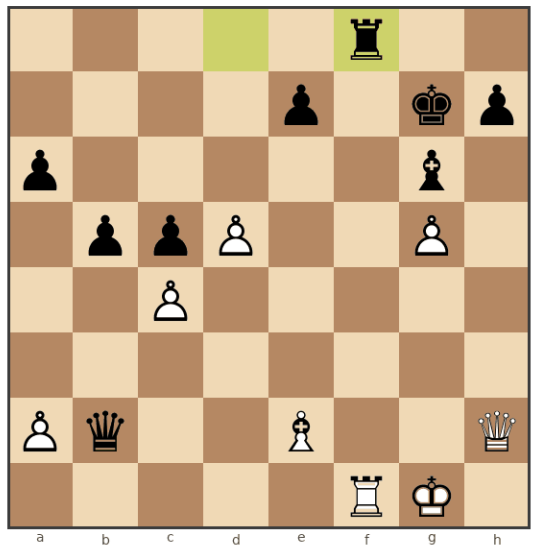
85. White to move · mate in 2



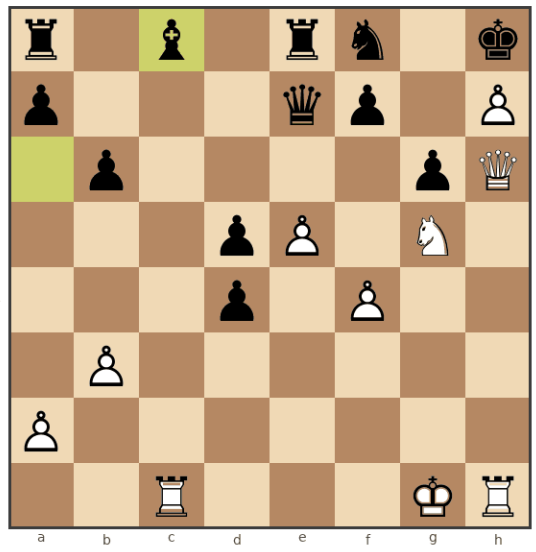
86. Black to move · mate in 2



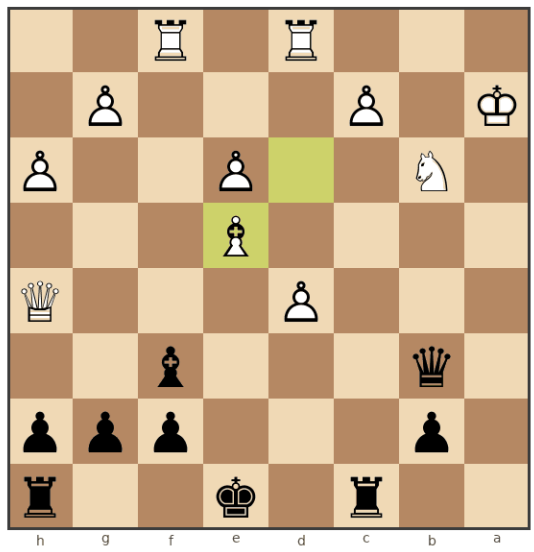
87. White to move · mate in 2



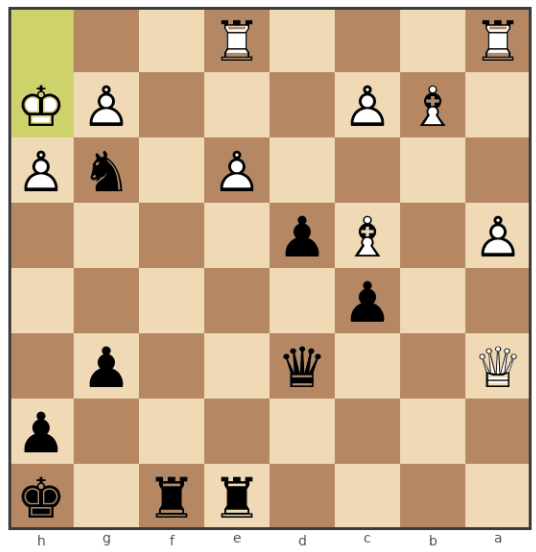
88. White to move · mate in 2



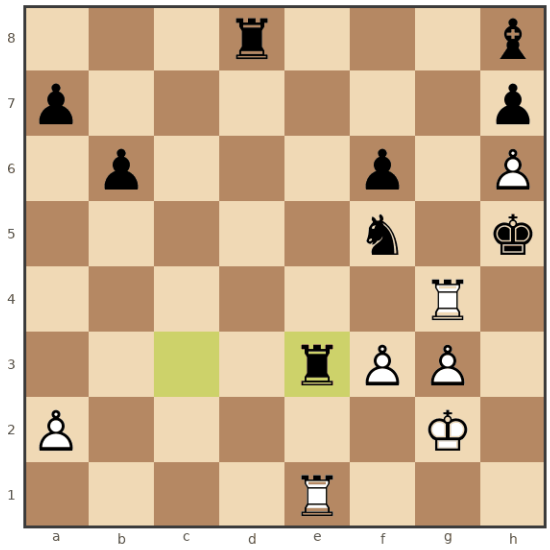
89. Black to move · mate in 2



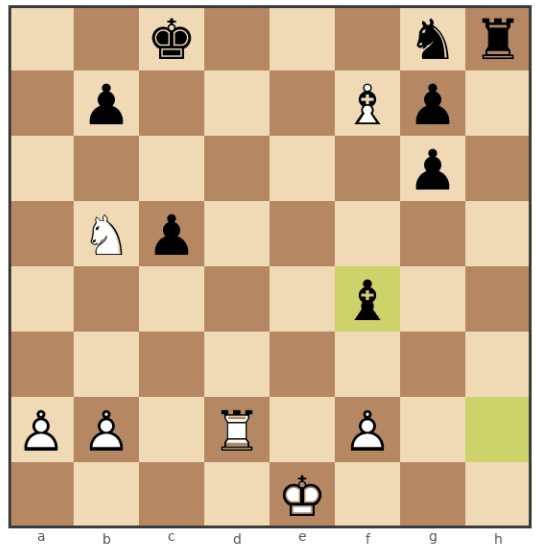
90. Black to move · mate in 2



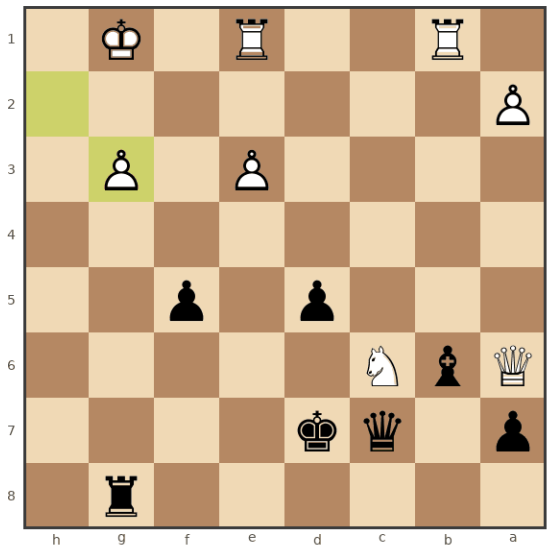
91. White to move · mate in 2



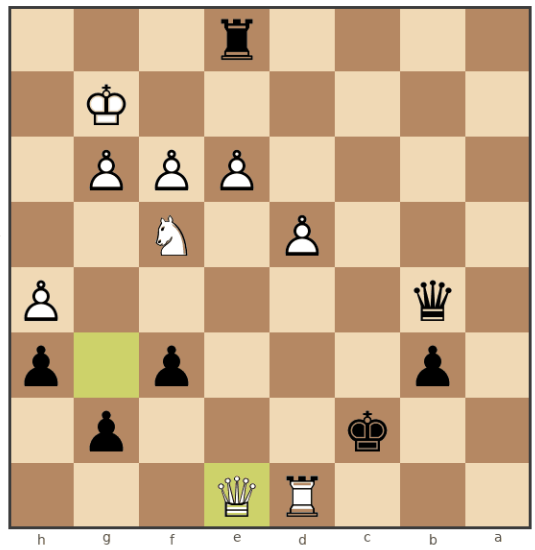
92. White to move · mate in 2



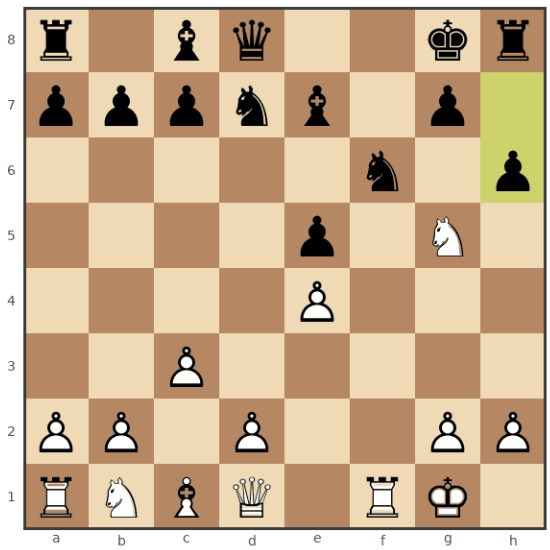
93. Black to move · mate in 2



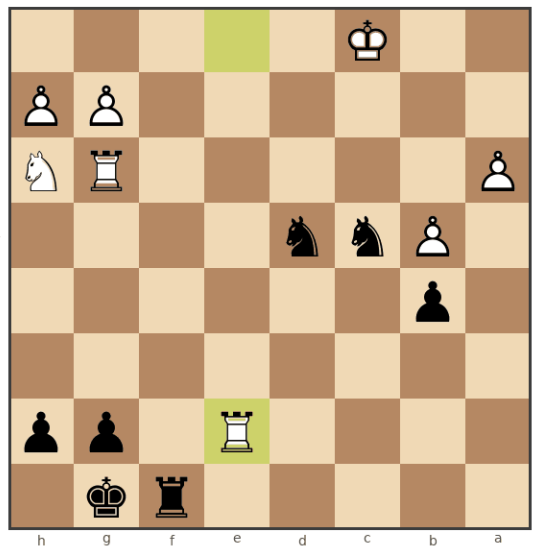
94. Black to move · mate in 2



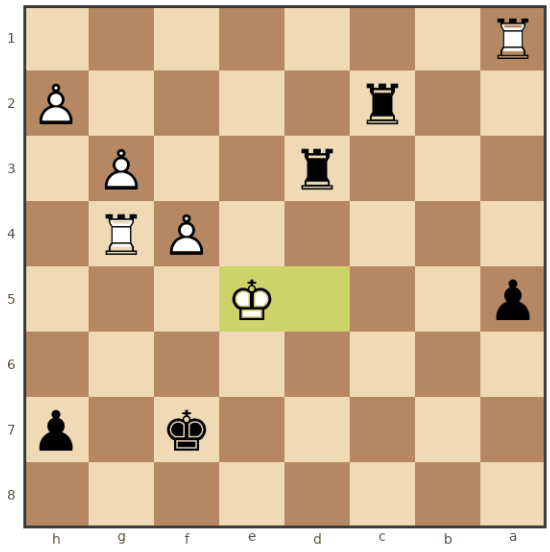
95. White to move · mate in 2



96. Black to move · mate in 2



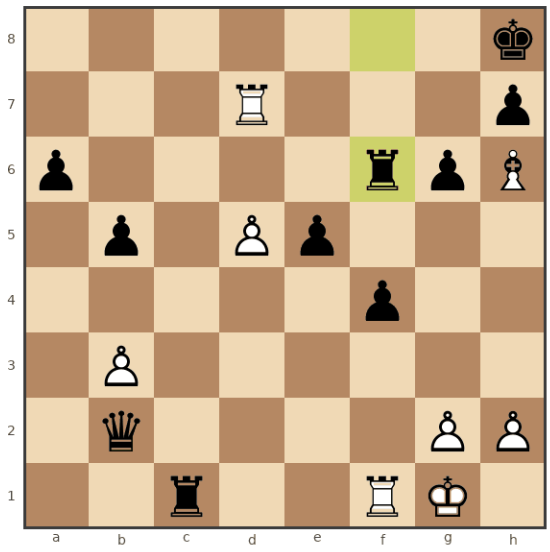
97. Black to move · mate in 2



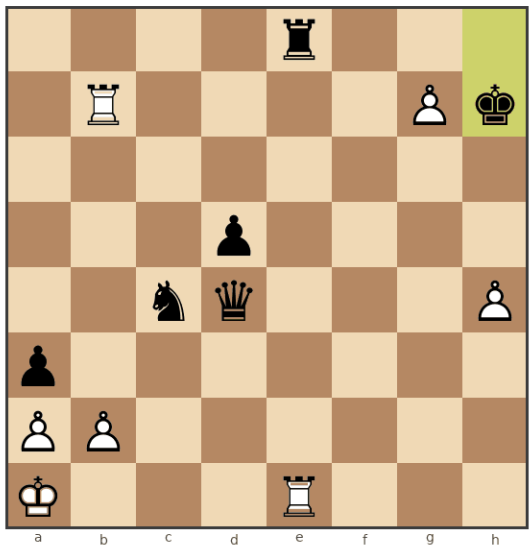
98. Black to move · mate in 2



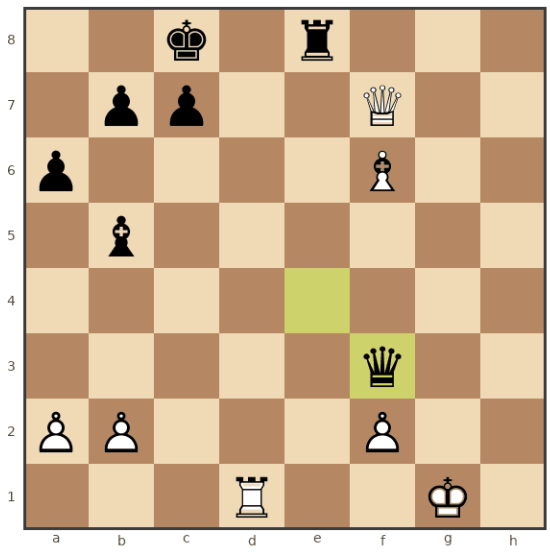
99. White to move · mate in 2



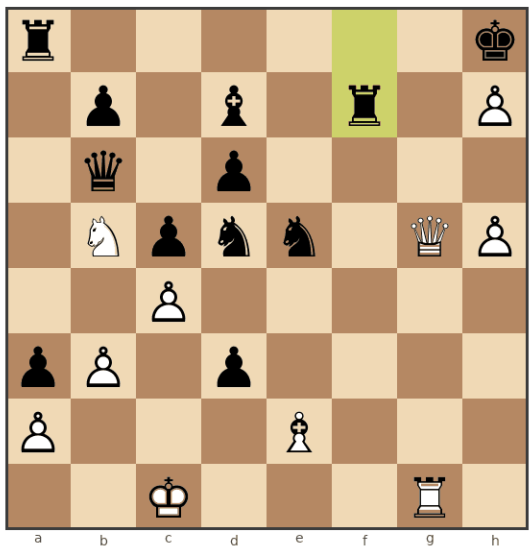
100. White to move · mate in 2



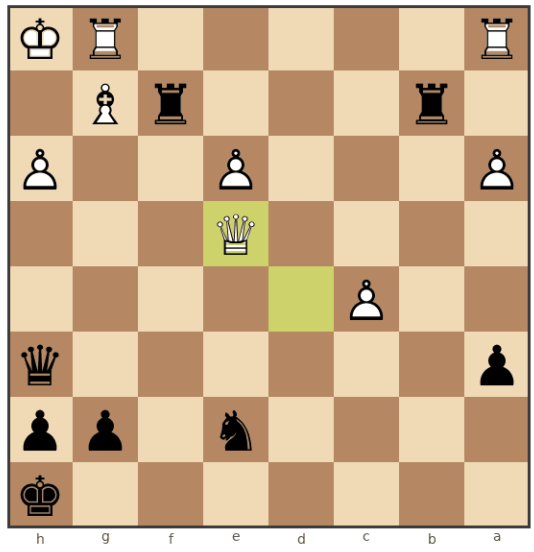
101. White to move · mate in 2



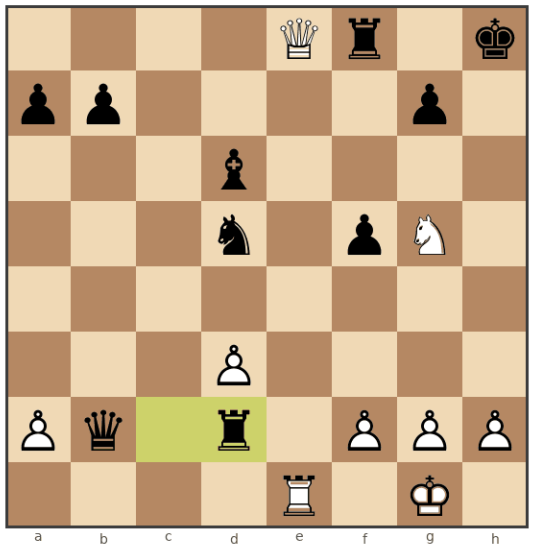
102. White to move · mate in 2



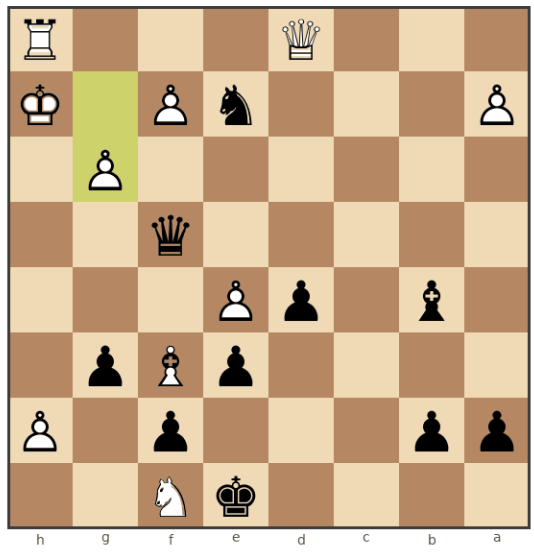
103. Black to move · mate in 2



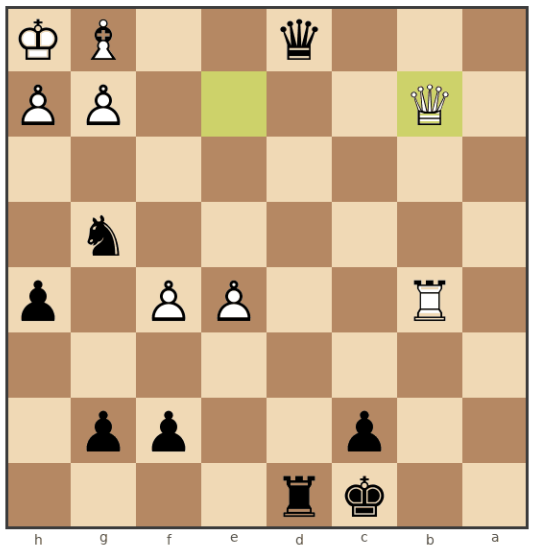
104. White to move · mate in 2



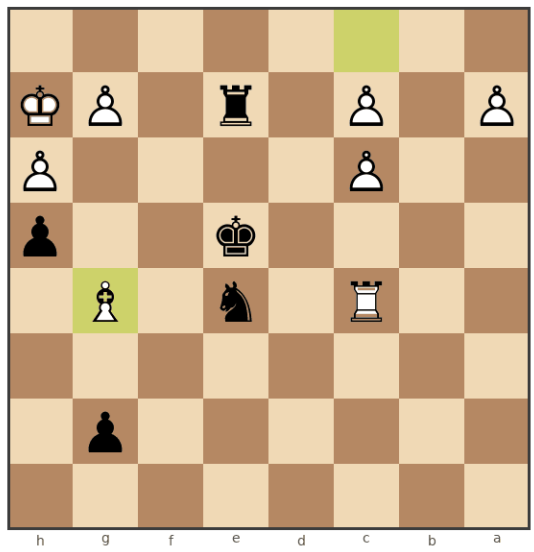
105. Black to move · mate in 2



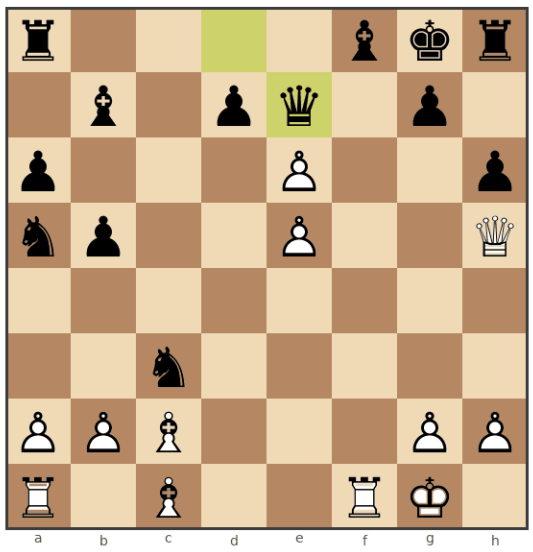
106. Black to move · mate in 2



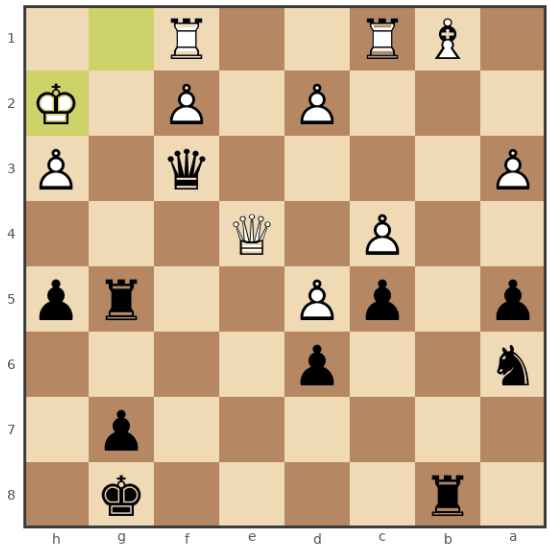
107. Black to move · mate in 2



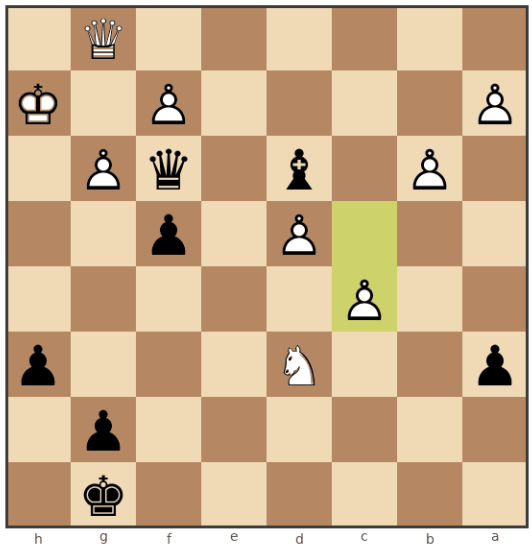
108. White to move · mate in 2



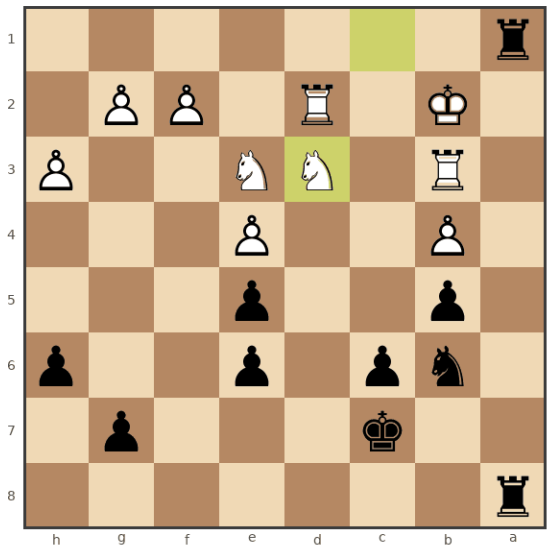
109. Black to move · mate in 2



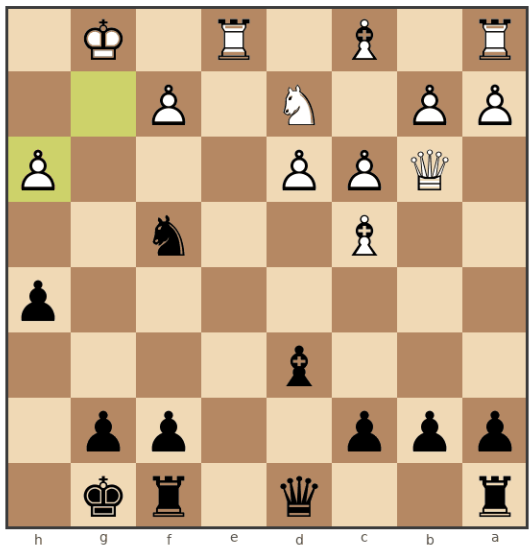
110. Black to move · mate in 2



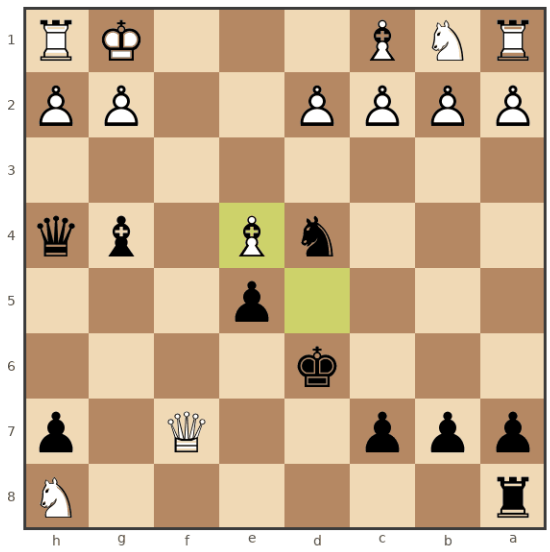
111. Black to move · mate in 2



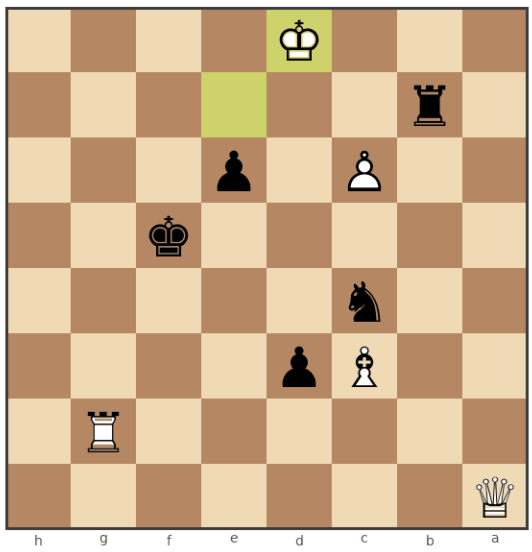
112. Black to move · mate in 2



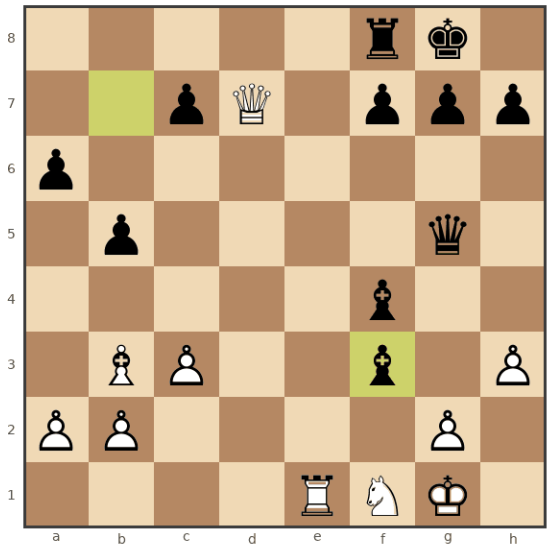
113. Black to move · mate in 2



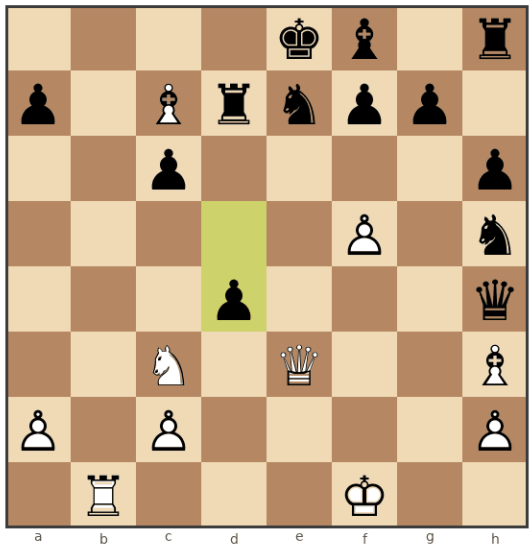
114. Black to move · mate in 2



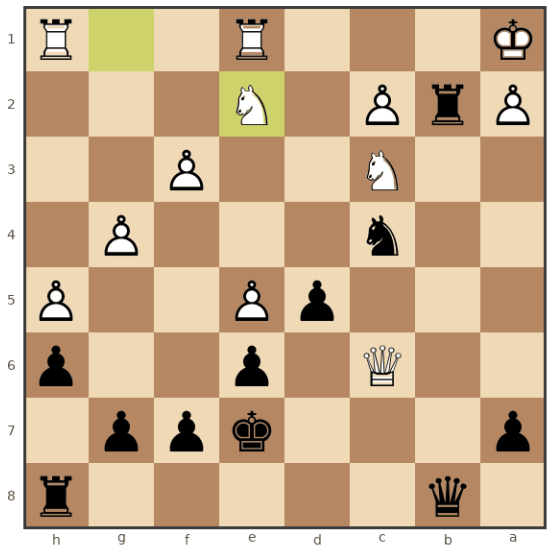
115. White to move · mate in 2



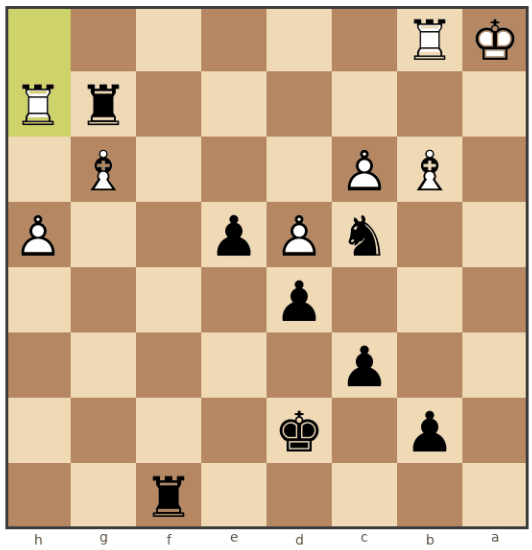
116. White to move · mate in 2



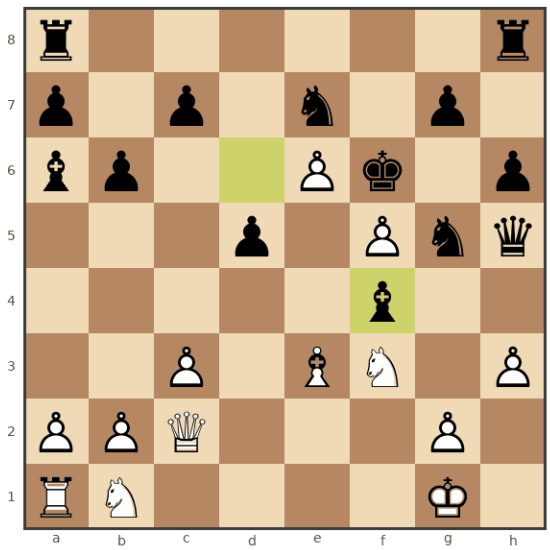
117. Black to move · mate in 2



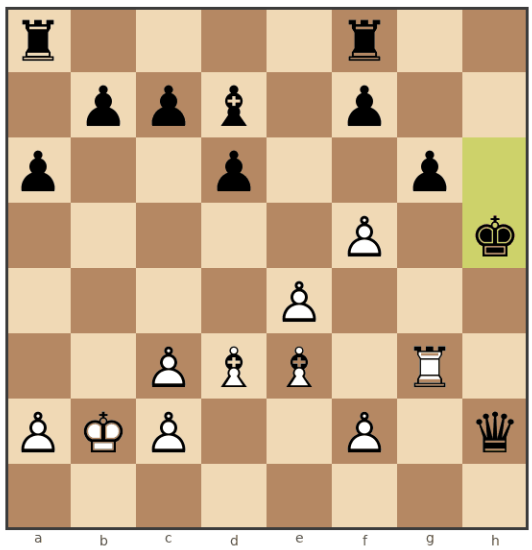
118. Black to move · mate in 2



119. White to move · mate in 2



120. White to move · mate in 2



Answers

1. 39... Bc3+ 40. Kc1 Re1# (rating 1000, lichess.org/training/062su)
2. 26. Qh4+ Kg7 27. Qh7# (rating 1033, lichess.org/training/0DAn2)
3. 19. Qh5+ Bh6 20. Qxh6# (rating 1044, lichess.org/training/03XGl)
4. 16... Qa1+ 17. Nb1 Qxb2# (rating 1064, lichess.org/training/0IiMz)
5. 16... Qxe3+ 17. Kf1 Qf2# (rating 1069, lichess.org/training/05CdA)
6. 33. Qxf7+ Kh8 34. Ng6# (rating 1092, lichess.org/training/0I2Ax)
7. 23... Qh2+ 24. Kf1 Ne3# (rating 1097, lichess.org/training/0AkKN)
8. 23... Bh2+ 24. Kh1 fxg2# (rating 1103, lichess.org/training/041KE)
9. 34... Qxh3+ 35. Nh2 Qxh2# (rating 1109, lichess.org/training/09UXL)
10. 38. Nxf6+ Kh8 39. Rxh7# (rating 1115, lichess.org/training/0Jyd0)
11. 34... Qa2+ 35. Kc1 Qc2# (rating 1123, lichess.org/training/03Xkm)
12. 26... Ng3+ 27. hxg3 Rh5# (rating 1128, lichess.org/training/01WoU)
13. 17. Bh7+ Nxh7 18. Qxh7# (rating 1133, lichess.org/training/05Zwg)
14. 17... Nxf3+ 18. gxf3 Qxh2# (rating 1135, lichess.org/training/01mxD)
15. 42. Rxh6+ Bxh6 43. Qxh6# (rating 1143, lichess.org/training/09K7c)
16. 21... Rc1+ 22. Rxc1 Qxc1# (rating 1145, lichess.org/training/0GcoL)
17. 25. Rxh6+ gxh6 26. Qxh6# (rating 1150, lichess.org/training/03eh3)
18. 15. Qg6+ Kh8 16. Qxh6# (rating 1154, lichess.org/training/01q3y)
19. 18. Nxf6+ gxf6 19. Qxh7# (rating 1155, lichess.org/training/0Ixuv)
20. 32. Qh6+ Bg7 33. Qxg7# (rating 1156, lichess.org/training/0B69d)
21. 24... Rxh3+ 25. Kg2 Rh2# (rating 1158, lichess.org/training/0ASEE)
22. 16. Ne7+ Kh8 17. Bxg7# (rating 1160, lichess.org/training/0FWfC)
23. 36... Qf4+ 37. Kh3 Qh4# (rating 1162, lichess.org/training/0KrR4)
24. 37... Re4+ 38. Kh5 Rh3# (rating 1165, lichess.org/training/035m4)
25. 12... Qd4+ 13. Be3 Qxe3# (rating 1166, lichess.org/training/07Pg2)
26. 22. Qh3+ Qh4 23. Qxh4# (rating 1171, lichess.org/training/01w3s)
27. 24... Rg8+ 25. Kh1 Qf3# (rating 1172, lichess.org/training/0BM26)
28. 25. Qxg6+ Kh8 26. Qg7# (rating 1175, lichess.org/training/0JaxG)
29. 27... Qb1+ 28. Rxb1 Rxb1# (rating 1179, lichess.org/training/08Jhb)
30. 34... Rxg1+ 35. Nxg1 Qg2# (rating 1182, lichess.org/training/07iic)
31. 36... h5+ 37. Kh3 g4# (rating 1186, lichess.org/training/01Yqt)
32. 31... Nf3+ 32. Bh2 Qxh2# (rating 1191, lichess.org/training/0557I)
33. 25. Qxf5+ exf5 26. Bxf5# (rating 1194, lichess.org/training/0ATrI)
34. 38. Nxa6+ Kc8 39. Qb8# (rating 1207, lichess.org/training/09JUw)
35. 24... Qd1+ 25. Rxd1 Rxd1# (rating 1213, lichess.org/training/0GGYD)
36. 40. Rh4+ Kg8 41. Rh8# (rating 1217, lichess.org/training/084V5)
37. 35. Qf8+ Rxf8 36. Rxf8# (rating 1220, lichess.org/training/0CWTj)
38. 36. Rh8+ Rg8 37. Rxg8# (rating 1224, lichess.org/training/05sUs)
39. 19. Qxf7+ Kh8 20. Qh7# (rating 1232, lichess.org/training/0JBXJ)
40. 24... Qxg2+ 25. Kd1 Qd2# (rating 1241, lichess.org/training/06tZw)

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41. 31. Qb3+ Ka5 32. Bc3# (rating 1245, lichess.org/training/0819L)
42. 41... Bf3+ 42. Kh3 Rh1# (rating 1254, lichess.org/training/0JnP1)
43. 29... f4+ 30. Kg4 f5# (rating 1260, lichess.org/training/02ncI)
44. 57. Rxf7+ Kg8 58. Rxe8# (rating 1262, lichess.org/training/0I1wj)
45. 23... Ng3+ 24. hxg3 Rh6# (rating 1263, lichess.org/training/0HbgT)
46. 49... Qh8+ 50. Kg5 Qh6# (rating 1268, lichess.org/training/0HZWS)
47. 30. Qe6+ Kd8 31. Nxb7# (rating 1275, lichess.org/training/0JBTr)
48. 36... Qg2+ 37. Ke1 Qe2# (rating 1277, lichess.org/training/0Dtii)
49. 22. Nh6+ Kg7 23. Qf6# (rating 1283, lichess.org/training/07oYs)
50. 22. Bh7+ Kh8 23. Rxf8# (rating 1289, lichess.org/training/0B9eZ)
51. 27... Bg4+ 28. Kg3 h4# (rating 1293, lichess.org/training/08sg9)
52. 39. Rxf8+ Bxf8 40. Qg8# (rating 1295, lichess.org/training/0HWag)
53. 36... Qh3+ 37. Kg1 Qxg2# (rating 1299, lichess.org/training/0Kqji)
54. 25. Rd6+ Ke5 26. Qe7# (rating 1302, lichess.org/training/0JfJY)
55. 31. Bf7+ Kh8 32. Qxf8# (rating 1306, lichess.org/training/0CqZj)
56. 24. Qd6+ Nd7 25. Qxd7# (rating 1307, lichess.org/training/0KI6O)
57. 29... Bh4+ 30. g3 Bxg3# (rating 1315, lichess.org/training/0BX0z)
58. 18. Ne5+ Kc8 19. Be6# (rating 1318, lichess.org/training/06ugD)
59. 28. Ng6+ hxg6 29. Rh3# (rating 1322, lichess.org/training/0ACuy)
60. 42. Rxh7+ Qxh7 43. Qxh7# (rating 1327, lichess.org/training/0BM2T)
61. 11. Qc8+ Ke7 12. Nf5# (rating 1330, lichess.org/training/0IkvQ)
62. 9... Bxc3+ 10. Qxc3 Qd1# (rating 1337, lichess.org/training/01EUl)
63. 34... Qf1+ 35. Kh2 Qxg2# (rating 1338, lichess.org/training/06Y4d)
64. 23... Qa1+ 24. Kc2 Qb2# (rating 1341, lichess.org/training/02YCM)
65. 26... Qxg3+ 27. Kh1 Qh3# (rating 1344, lichess.org/training/03tWQ)
66. 27... Rxf2+ 28. Ke1 Rg1# (rating 1346, lichess.org/training/05KVJ)
67. 34... Kh3+ 35. Kh1 Rxh2# (rating 1348, lichess.org/training/0ElbW)
68. 15... Bxd3+ 16. cxd3 Qxf2# (rating 1355, lichess.org/training/0Dg0b)
69. 22... Qxb1+ 23. Kxb1 Ra1# (rating 1358, lichess.org/training/00aDl)
70. 46. Qf8+ Kd7 47. e6# (rating 1366, lichess.org/training/05OmH)
71. 22... Qd2+ 23. Kf1 Qxf2# (rating 1371, lichess.org/training/0HoXP)
72. 34. Qg6+ Qg7 35. Qxg7# (rating 1374, lichess.org/training/07CHw)
73. 26. Qe8+ Kh7 27. g6# (rating 1379, lichess.org/training/0KdRl)
74. 32. Rd8+ Kc7 33. Qe7# (rating 1382, lichess.org/training/028W0)
75. 7. Bxf7+ Kd7 8. Qe6# (rating 1384, lichess.org/training/04AXr)
76. 28... Qxh3+ 29. gxh3 Rxh3# (rating 1388, lichess.org/training/036WH)
77. 24. Qb5+ Kd8 25. Nxf7# (rating 1391, lichess.org/training/069CB)
78. 33. Rg7+ Bxg7 34. Qxg7# (rating 1392, lichess.org/training/0Bxfo)
79. 55... Be3+ 56. g5 Bxg5# (rating 1397, lichess.org/training/06fJG)
80. 32. Rxh6+ gxh6 33. Qg8# (rating 1399, lichess.org/training/0BmKe)

Answers

81. 19... h4+ 20. Kf3 Nd4# (rating 1403, lichess.org/training/01hRk)
82. 29... Qxh3+ 30. gxh3 Rxh3# (rating 1409, lichess.org/training/05mQm)
83. 18... Ng3+ 19. hxg3 Qh5# (rating 1415, lichess.org/training/01ehq)
84. 21... Rxf1+ 22. Rxf1 Qxh2# (rating 1420, lichess.org/training/0AKWD)
85. 22. gxf7+ Kh8 23. Qg8# (rating 1431, lichess.org/training/0D3eZ)
86. 26... Qh3+ 27. Kg1 Qxg2# (rating 1436, lichess.org/training/09krd)
87. 32. Qh6+ Kh8 33. Qxf8# (rating 1441, lichess.org/training/0JNWs)
88. 32. Qg7+ Kxg7 33. h8=Q# (rating 1447, lichess.org/training/03VYl)
89. 22... Ra8+ 23. Kb1 Ra1# (rating 1453, lichess.org/training/0Hgmt)
90. 28... Nf1+ 29. Kg1 Qh2# (rating 1459, lichess.org/training/0GyoW)
91. 34. Rh1+ Nh4+ 35. Rhxh4# (rating 1463, lichess.org/training/0AH5m)
92. 28. Be6+ Kb8 29. Rd8# (rating 1468, lichess.org/training/06Tp7)
93. 32... Qxg3+ 33. Kf1 Qg2# (rating 1470, lichess.org/training/01eqy)
94. 46... Qf1+ 47. Kh2 Qh1# (rating 1482, lichess.org/training/04n3R)
95. 10. Qb3+ Nd5 11. Qxd5# (rating 1486, lichess.org/training/0AasD)
96. 30... Rf1+ 31. Re1 Rxe1# (rating 1492, lichess.org/training/0IGru)
97. 44... Re2+ 45. Kf5 Rd5# (rating 1500, lichess.org/training/09Aly)
98. 14... Bxf2+ 15. Kh1 Ng3# (rating 1502, lichess.org/training/06Owt)
99. 27. Rd8+ Rf8 28. Rxf8# (rating 1504, lichess.org/training/07u8v)
100. 38. g8=Q+ Kxg8 39. Rxe8# (rating 1507, lichess.org/training/06IxM)
101. 26. Qxe8+ Bxe8 27. Rd8# (rating 1509, lichess.org/training/0FOuA)
102. 29. Qg8+ Rxg8 30. hxg8=Q# (rating 1512, lichess.org/training/0F2ke)
103. 32... Qxh3+ 33. Bxh3 Rh2# (rating 1516, lichess.org/training/0Isbc)
104. 28. Qh5+ Kg8 29. Qh7# (rating 1518, lichess.org/training/0Ge5o)
105. 26... Qxf2+ 27. Kh3 Qxg3# (rating 1520, lichess.org/training/0BU4u)
106. 28... Qxg1+ 29. Kxg1 Rd1# (rating 1526, lichess.org/training/022ib)
107. 33... Nf3+ 34. Kh1 Re1# (rating 1527, lichess.org/training/0ABk4)
108. 17. Qf7+ Qxf7 18. exf7# (rating 1534, lichess.org/training/0H6cl)
109. 29... Rg2+ 30. Kh1 Qxh3# (rating 1539, lichess.org/training/03nXf)
110. 40... Qh5+ 41. Kg2 f3# (rating 1544, lichess.org/training/0HNXV)
111. 32... R8a2+ 33. Kc3 Na4# (rating 1551, lichess.org/training/052aq)
112. 15... Qg5+ 16. Kf1 Qg2# (rating 1555, lichess.org/training/0FBUL)
113. 16... Qe1+ 17. Qf1 Ne2# (rating 1558, lichess.org/training/0DTS7)
114. 50... e2+ 51. Kc1 Nd3# (rating 1560, lichess.org/training/0DZXq)
115. 22. Qxf7+ Rxf7 23. Re8# (rating 1565, lichess.org/training/0HV7e)
116. 24. Rb8+ Rd8 25. Rxd8# (rating 1568, lichess.org/training/08ixO)
117. 26... Rxa2+ 27. Nxa2 Qb2# (rating 1577, lichess.org/training/00rNc)
118. 38... Ra8+ 39. Ba2 Raxa2# (rating 1583, lichess.org/training/0B9Q5)
119. 23. Bd4+ Be5 24. Bxe5# (rating 1586, lichess.org/training/0FgOs)
120. 27. Be2+ Kh4 28. Bg5# (rating 1592, lichess.org/training/00WqT)